Who Killed Cock Robin

Des phy Sallau syou coutti

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COMET MAGAZINE
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Who Killed Cock Robin

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Velox Et Luminosus

Who Killed Cock Robin?





Who killed Cock Robin? I, said the Sparrow,
With my bow and arrow, I killed Cock Robin.

Who saw him die? I, said the Fly.
With my little eyes, I saw him die.

Who caught his blood? I, said the Fish,
With my little dish, I caught his blood.

Who'll make his shroud? I, said the Beetle,
With my thread and needle, I'll make the shroud.

Who'll dig his grave? I, said the Owl,
With my pick and shovel, I'll dig his grave.

Who'll be the parson? I, said the Rook,
With my little book, I'll be the parson.

Who'll be the clerk? I, said the Lark,
If it's not in the dark, I'll be the clerk.

Who'll carry the link? I, said the Linnet,
I'll fetch it in a minute, I'll carry the link.

All the birds
of the air
Came to see
the funeral
of
Cock Robin.

And the beasts
of the field
Came also
to see
the funeral
of
Cock Robin.









Who Killed Cock Robin?



Who'll be chief mourner? I, said the Dove,
I mourn for my love, I'll be chief mourner.

Who'll carry the coffin? I, said the Kite,
If it's not through the night, I'll carry the coffin.

Who'll bear the pall? We, said the Wren,
Both the cock and the hen, We'll bear the pall.

Who'll sing a psalm? I, said the Thrush,
As she sat on a bush, I'll sing a psalm.

Who'll toll the bell? I, said the Bull,
Because I can pull, I'll toll the bell.

So Cock Robin, farewell.
All the birds of the air
Fell a-sighing and a-sobbing,
When they heard the bell toll
For poor Cock Robin.

NOTICE
To all it concerns, This notice apprises,
The Sparrow's for trial, At next bird assizes.







All the birds of the air Came to see the funeral of Cock Robin.

And the beasts of the field Came also to see the funeral of Cock Robin.

The Man Who Knew Infinity



Srinivasa Ramanujan (1887-1920)

> “An equation for me has no meaning unless it expresses a thought of God.”
>
> — Srinivasa Ramanujan

Have you ever met someone who could see numbers the way others see colors? Srinivasa Ramanujan (1887–1920) was exactly that kind of person. Born into a poor family in southern India, he grew up to become one of the greatest mathematicians the world has ever known — and he did it with almost no formal training.

Ramanujan’s love for mathematics began early. At age 16, he found a book called *A Synopsis of Elementary Results* in Pure and Applied Mathematics, which contained thousands of theorems. Instead of just reading them, he worked through every single one on his own and then went far beyond, creating his own formulas. He was so obsessed with math that he failed all his other subjects in college and lost his scholarship. For a while, he was poor and unemployed, but he never stopped doing mathematics.

In 1912, Ramanujan was working as a clerk in Madras when he decided to write a letter to G.H. Hardy, a famous mathematician at Cambridge University. Hardy almost threw the letter away — the formulas looked like nonsense. But something made him look again. What he saw was genius. Hardy immediately invited Ramanujan to England, and in 1914, the young Indian clerk sailed to Cambridge. Their collaboration became one of the most extraordinary partnerships in the history of mathematics.

Together, they made breakthroughs in number theory, infinite series, and the theory of partitions. Ramanujan had a magical intuition for numbers. He once told Hardy that his family goddess revealed mathematical truths to him in his dreams. But his methods were unconventional — he often wrote down results without proofs because to him, the beauty of the formula was its own proof.

Perhaps the most famous story about Ramanujan involves a taxi. Hardy once visited him in the hospital and mentioned that he had come in taxi number 1729, which he thought was “rather a dull number”. Ramanujan immediately replied: “No, Hardy, it is a very interesting number. It is the smallest number expressible as the sum of two cubes in two different ways”. (Indeed, $1729 = 1^3 + 12^3 = 9^3 + 10^3$.) Today, 1729 is known as the Hardy–Ramanujan number.

Tragically, Ramanujan’s health failed him in England. He returned to India in 1919 and died the following year at just 32 years old. But in his short life, he left behind nearly 3,900 results — formulas, identities, and theorems that continue to inspire mathematicians today. His work is now used in fields as diverse as crystallography and string theory. In 2011, India declared his birthday, December 22, as National Mathematics Day.

$$\frac{1}{\pi} = \frac{2\sqrt{2}}{99^2} \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{(4k)!\,(1103 + 26390k)}{(k!)^4 396^{4k}}$$

One of Ramanujan’s formulas for calculating PI remains unknown to this day how these unexpected figures were derived.

Ramanujan’s story teaches us that genius can come from anywhere — even from a poor village in India, with nothing but a book and a burning love for numbers. He once wrote: “I have not trodden through the conventional regular course... but I am striking out a new path for myself”. And that new path changed mathematics forever.

Everywhere at the End of Time

"Everywhere at the End of Time" is a six-stage ambient music series by *The Caretaker* that sonically explores the progression of *dementia*, from early memory loss to complete cognitive decay.
(NOTE: The whole song lasts for 6h30min. If you have the patience, you can try to listen it to the end.)

Dementia

/dəˈmen(t)SH(ē)ə/

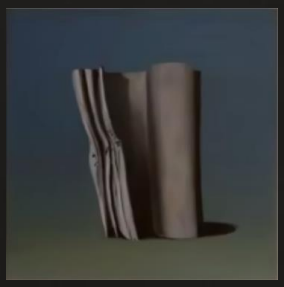
A chronic or persistent disorder of the mental processes caused by brain disease or injury and marked by memory disorders, personality changes, and impaired reasoning.

Heartaches – Al Bowlly
(EATEOT sampled this song)
Heartaches, heartaches
My loving you meant only heartaches
Your kiss was such a sacred thing to me
I can't believe it's just a burning memory
Heartaches, heartaches
What does it matter how my heart breaks
I should be happy with someone new
But my heart aches for you



BEFORE IT STARTS

Where memories are unharmed. Where the most precious pieces of memories seem to stay with you forever. You will be appreciated every single piece of it before it happens.



STAGE 1

Here we experience the first signs of memory loss. This stage is most like a beautiful daydream. The glory of old age and recollection. The last of the great days.



STAGE 2

The second stage is the self realisation and awareness that something is wrong with a refusal to accept that. More effort is made to remember so memories can be more long form with a little more deterioration in quality. The overall personal mood is generally lower than the first stage and at a point before confusion starts setting in.



STAGE 3

Here we are presented with some of the last coherent memories before confusion fully rolls in and the grey mists form and fade away. Finest moments have been remembered, the musical flow in places is more confused and tangled. Some memories become more isolated, broken and distant. These are the last embers of awareness before we enter the post-awareness stages.



STAGE 4

Post-Awareness Stage 4 is where serenity and the ability to recall singular memories gives way to confusions and horror. It’s the beginning of an eventual process where all memories begin to become more fluid through entanglements, repetition and rupture.



STAGE 5

Post-Awareness Stage 5 confusions and horror. More extreme entanglements, repetition and rupture can give way to calmer moments. The unfamiliar may sound and feel familiar. Time is often spent only in the moment leading to isolation.



STAGE 6

Post-Awareness Stage 6 is without description.

NOTE

The last minute of the STAGE 6 of the original song is completely silent, symbolizing the patient's death

CARE FOR DEMENTIA PATIENTS

祈愿

Des phy Sallau syou coutti.

Who Killed Cock Robin?



"Who Killed Cock Robin" is an enigmatic level of the Backrooms C-Cluster.

Description

This level is often referred to by wanderers as the "Mirror Level." Due to its appearance manifesting as a mirror image of other levels, and possessing the latter's physical properties, but devoid of entities and anomalous effects, the environment sometimes exhibits sections different from the original level, accompanied by slight flickering and color shifts, which can be used to determine one's location.

So far, the level mirrors recorded within this level include: Level 37, Level C-100, Level C-850, etc.

This level can only be entered by three or more people no-clipping simultaneously, and no one can leave or additional wanderers can no-clip in until the anomalous effects have ended.

The most significant difference between this level and the original levels lies in its mental hazard. Specifically, one of the wanderers who enter this level will exhibit symptoms similar to "*Nihilistic Delusion*"[1], manifesting as a belief that they are disappearing, and gradually affecting the subjective perceptions of others, causing the other wanderers to believe that they have died.

> Who killed Cock Robin?
>
> "I."
>
> Said the Sparrow.

The remaining wanderers, after the first abnormal wanderer "disappears," will subsequently develop symptoms similar to "*Delusion of Sins*"[2], believing that the latter's "death" was their own fault, and attempting to conceal their "sin," which may lead to a series of absurd actions, such as claiming to hold an extremely exaggerated funeral for them, or accusing others of taking the blame for them, etc.

> Who killed Cock Robin?
>
> "The Sparrow."
>
> I said.

At this point, due to the mutual suspicion among the remaining wanderers, the atmosphere among them becomes tense. Individual wanderers may be unable to bear the inner guilt and anxiety and step forward to voluntarily confess their "sin"; this wanderer is usually executed by the others in the name of judgment. If no one confesses from beginning to end, the wanderers will either turn on each other or unanimously accuse a single person. The former often results in multiple deaths or serious injuries, while the latter sacrifices one person as a "scapegoat."



Cock Robin is dead. What comes next?

> <Incident Record>
>
> On [redacted], 8 wanderers no-clipped into this level. They no-clipped out of this level on [redacted], with only 2 remaining. Diagnosed with severe schizophrenia and persecutory delusions, these 2 survivors are currently receiving treatment at Alpha Base.

Below is the interview record of one of the survivors:

> Researcher [redacted]: Hello, wanderer.
>
> [redacted]: (Inaudible muttering)
>
> Researcher [redacted]: How are you feeling?
>
> [redacted]: (Silence)
>
> Researcher [redacted]: (Cheerfully) It seems you're much better now. Would you be willing to talk about what happened in that level?
>
> [redacted]: (Whispering) ...Beasts.
>
> Researcher [redacted]: I'm sorry, what did you say?
>
> [redacted]: (Speaking extremely fast) The beasts tore at each other, they killed everyone, and then God came.
>
> Researcher [redacted]: What do you mean by "God"?
>
> [redacted]: (Vacant stare)
>
> [After this, [redacted] never again responded to Researcher [redacted]'s questions.]
>
> <End of Record>

Bases, Outposts, and Communities

Due to the anomalous effects within this level, no bases have been stationed here yet.

Why is this?

Entrances and Exits:

Entrances

You are guilty. You say you did nothing wrong, but you know deep down this is self-deception.

> Have you ever done something that troubles your conscience?
>
> If so, it doesn't matter. Because most people in this world live with guilt, day after day.

Exits

> Let it go unresolved, perhaps this is the best outcome.

Footnotes

1. Nihilistic Delusion: In psychiatry, the delusion of nonexistence. The patient believes he no longer exists, that his mind or a part of his body is missing, or that the world itself has ceased to be. It occurs primarily in schizophrenic reactions and depressive states, particularly in acute depression. They are also observed in occasional cases of general paresis, psychosis with cerebral arteriosclerosis, and the depressed and agitated type of senile dementia.
2. Delusion of Sins: It often referred to clinically as a Sinful Delusion or Delusion of Guilt, is defined as a pathological, fixed, and irrational belief that one has committed a grave transgression, crime, or sin, despite overwhelming evidence to the contrary or a trivial nature of the supposed offense.

Men Who Conned the World

In the 1960s something strange started happening on farms. Amidst the uniform blanket of wheat, spiraling circular designs were appearing.

These intricate and often stunning patterns that appeared overnight in fields of crops have puzzled scientists, farmers, and amateur sleuths for decades. While some argue that they are the work of human artists or elaborate hoaxes, others believe that they hold a deeper, more mystical significance.

However, for some circles at least, the solution was much more down to earth than the believers wanted to admit. This is the story of Doug and Dave, the men who conned the world.

What are Crop Circles?

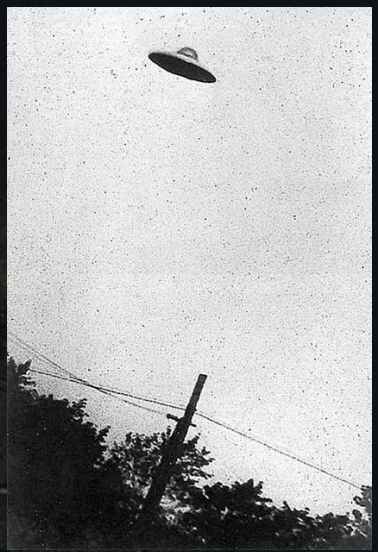
But, before we get to the how, let's cover the what. What exactly is a crop circle? Anyone who's ever seen an alien invasion film, or the X-files, has likely seen one. A crop circle is a pattern created by flattening a crop, usually some kind of cereal.

The term is relatively new, having first been coined by a man called Colin Andrews in the 1980s. To some, crop circles are proof that aliens exist, to some they're evidence that another supernatural phenomenon exists, but to many, they're proof that people have too much time on their hands.



Crop Circle

When crop circles first started appearing in the 1960s, during the height of UFO mania, people began referring to them as "UFO nests". They then became increasingly common throughout the 1970s and the number of reports has substantially increased since then.



The US went a little crazy for UFOs in the 1950s and 1960s (Taken by George Stock)

While most people think of crop circles as being a relatively young phenomena, their history actually stretches back much further than one might think. Some crop circles "experts" point to a pamphlet from 1678 as the first evidence of crop circles.

The ***Mowing-Devil: Strange News Out of Hartfordshire*** describes strange shapes being made in the fields of England. However, it describes the stalks as being cut, rather than bent.

In 1686, Robert Plot, an English naturalist described a strange occurrence similar to crop circles. He noted rings or arcs of mushrooms (aka fairy rings) which he put down to air flows from the sky. Some modern meteorologists have seen a link between his book, ***The Natural History of Stafford-Shire***, and more modern occurrences of crop circles.

Then, in 1880, an amateur scientist wrote to the magazine Nature after finding several circles of flattened crops in the fields near his home. Rather than blaming aliens, he believed the cause to be "cyclonic wind action," tornadoes basically.

20th Century

The history of "true" crop circles doesn't really kick off until the 20th century. In 1932 an archaeologist discovered four strange rings in a field near Chichester, England. Under further investigation, he found that the barley had been beaten down while the interior was slightly raised. No explanation was found.

30 years later in Wiltshire, England, a large crater was found in the middle of a potato field. In the fields surrounding the impact site, there were several areas where the wheat had been flattened in a circular shape.

They seemed to have been flattened in a spiral shape, which some people believed was due to air currents resulting from the impact. The astronomer Hugh Ernest Butler believed they were the result of lightning strikes. Still no aliens.

Then UFO mania hit a fever pitch in the 1960s. This started a surge of UFO-related corn circle sightings. In the August of 1967, three circles were found in a field in Alberta, Canada. The government sent in Department of National Defense investigators who believed the circles were artificial but had no idea how they had been made.

The most famous case came in 1966 in Tully, Queensland, Australia. A farmer claimed to have seen a strange saucer-shaped craft rise from a nearby swamp and then fly away.

Upon investigating the area, he found a large circular patch where the grass had been flattened in clockwise curves. Investigators from the local police force as well as the University of Queensland put the circles down to natural causes, most likely a down draught, dust devil, or waterspout.



The Jellyfish crop circle in Oxfordshire, England

Throughout the 1960s rumors spread of "saucer nests" being found throughout Wiltshire in England. Unfortunately, no one ever thought to photograph them.

As time marched on the crop circles began to change. Prior to the 1970s, they had always been simple circles, easy to explain away. But by the end of the 70s, the crop circles had become much more intricate, and much more difficult to explain.

Bower and Chorley: Pranksters Extraordinaire

What we think of as "crop circles" today can actually be put down to two men from Wiltshire, England. In 1991, Doug Bower and Dave Chorley made waves in the UFO world by claiming they had started the modern crop circle phenomenon in 1978.

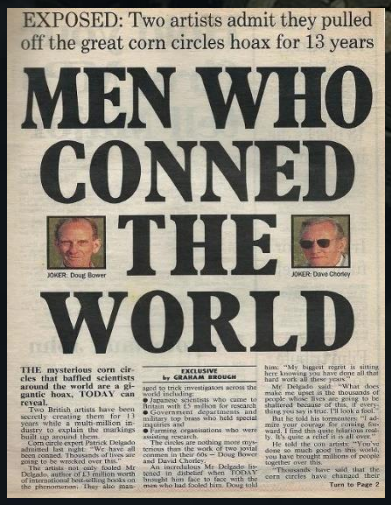


Doug Bower and Dave Chorley

The two men were having a drink together one evening, and after having heard about the local "saucer nests" decided to try making their own. Using just a wooden plank, a bit of rope, and a baseball cap with some wire attached they managed to make perfect circles in the corn.



The Way They Made Crop Circles



EXPOSED: Two artists admit they pulled off the great corn circles hoax for 13 years

MEN WHO CONNED THE WORLD

JOKER: Doug Bower

JOKER: Dave Chorley

THE mysterious corn circles that baffled scientists around the world are a gigantic hoax, TODAY can reveal.

Two British artists have been secretly creating them for 13 years while a multi-million industry to explain the markings built up around them.

Corn circle expert Patrick Delgado admitted last night: "We have all been conned. Thousands of lives are going to be wrecked over this."

The artists not only fooled Mr Delgado, author of a shelf-load of international best-selling books on the phenomenon. They also pranked to trick investigators across the world including:

- Japanese scientists who came to Britain with £5 million for research
- Government departments and agencies in Russia who held special inquiries
- Farming organisations who were assisting research.

The circles are nothing more mysterious than the work of two jovial conmen in their 60s – Doug Bower and David Chorley.

An incredulous Mr Delgado last night admitted when TODAY brought him face to face with the men who had fooled him. Doug told him: "My biggest regret is sitting here knowing you have done all that hard work all these years."

Mr Delgado said: "What does make me upset is the thousands of people whose lives are going to be shattered because of this, if everything you say is true. I'll look a fool.

But he told his tormentors: "Seriously, I find this quite hilarious really. It's quite a relief it is all over."

He told the con artists: "You've done so much good to this world, you have brought millions of people together over this.

"Thousands have said that the corn circles have changed their

Turn to Page 2

The newspaper that published them

Many self-appointed "cereologists" (people who believe crop circles hide secret messages) refused to believe two normal men could be behind their life's work. So, the two made a circle in front of journalists and invited cereolgist Pat Delgado to come and inspect it.

Delgado examined the pair's work and declared it to be authentic. He was somewhat disappointed to hear it was a hoax. Bower and Chorley claimed to have made all crop circles running up to 1987 and over 200 between 1978 and 1991.

It seems pretty clear then that besides the circles caused by nature, Bower and Chorley were likely responsible for the rash of crop circles spotted in the late 20th century. Not everyone is convinced, however.

In the time the two pranksters claimed to have made 200 crop circles, a further 1,000 were spotted elsewhere. So far around 10,000 crop circles have been found, many of them in countries the two men have never visited.

Cereologists have claimed this is evidence that not all crop circles are man-made. As the circles have become more complex, with some including up to 1000 distinct shapes, believers have become convinced that the crop circles hold secret messages.



Crop circles have become ever more complex and intricate, and there are even (human) competitions to design the best

In reality, it's clear that the two pranksters inspired a wave of copycats. Crop circles have become an art form, with some places using them to try and draw in tourists.

There are even annual competitions where people compete to make the most complex designs they can. It's become big business in some areas, with some crop circle designers making good money using their circles to promote companies.

Like so many conspiracy theories, this one doesn't stand up to any scrutiny. Most amazingly, even with the confessions of Bower and Chorley, and all the evidence to the contrary, some people still believe. It's hard to know if their insistence on believing is impressive or worrying.

Who Killed Cock Robin

CHAPTER 1. I DON'T REMEMBER HOW I NO-CLIPPED

I don't remember how I no-clipped into this level.

The last frame of my memory is the tiled hallway of Level 37. Water covered my ankles, and white fluorescent tubes buzzed above my head. I had heard that sound for too long. It was no longer just noise; it had become something like a heartbeat. Then the water under my feet suddenly got deeper. It didn't get deeper slowly. It collapsed all at once, as if an invisible mouth were hidden under the tiles and swallowed me whole.

The feeling of drowning lasted only a moment. Then came weightlessness, and then my feet hit solid ground again. Cold water covered my ankles. The temperature was normal. The light was normal. Everything looked normal.

But I didn't move, because I realized one thing at once—the buzzing of the tubes was gone. In its place was a very faint sound, like feathers rubbing against air. It came from far away down the hallway, and also seemed to come from inside my own head.

I stood in the same tiled hallway. Water still covered my ankles, and the light was still that uneasy cold white. But something was wrong. The seams between the tiles were slightly off. The lines should have run straight to the end of the hallway, but at some point they bent strangely by a fraction of a degree. The light flickered sometimes, so briefly that I almost thought it was my imagination. The water was warm, a little warmer than body temperature. I crouched down to look at my reflection. The face in the reflection was smiling. I was clearly afraid.

"You got sucked in too?"

I turned around sharply. Two people stood behind me, a man and a woman, both in light M.E.G. equipment. The man spoke. He was about thirty, with a scar running from his cheekbone to his ear, and his eyes were alert. The woman was younger. She stood behind him with her arms crossed, her lips pale.

"My name is K," the man said. "This is Emma. We were recording water levels in Level 37, and then we ended up here."

"Where is here?"

"I don't know." K looked around. "But it's definitely not Level 37."

CHAPTER 2. PEELED-OFF SKIN

We walked along the hallway for about twenty minutes and found the first piece of evidence: a door. A sign on it said “Laboratory Area C,” but the room behind the door was completely different from the labs in Level 37. Some kind of vine grew on the walls, spreading from the corners to the ceiling. In the center of the room was a table. On the table lay an open notebook, its handwriting messy.

“It remembers me.” “It knows my name.” “It says I killed someone.”

Three sentences, repeated for more than ten pages. I closed the notebook. Emma glanced at the cover, and her fingers trembled slightly.

The space in this level was like skin peeled off other levels. K stopped at the third corner and stared at the ground for a long time. He said he recognized it. This stretch of road was exactly the same as a hallway in Level C-100, even the long thin crack in the floor tiles was in the same place. But in the original level, that crack was straight. Here it curved, like a scar that had half healed.

“A mirror,” K said in a low voice. “This is a mirror level. It copied the skin of other levels, but not what was inside them. The entities and abnormal effects here don’t exist, but something is here.”

Emma looked up. She said that from just now, she had been hearing a sound.

“What sound?”

“Wings,” she said. “The sound of flapping wings. Very big, like some bird has been following us flying, but I can’t see anything.”

K and I both went silent. I heard nothing. K heard nothing either. But Emma’s expression was very certain, and from the moment she said that, her condition began to get worse. At first she only spaced out sometimes. Later she began to stop often, tilting her head, as if listening to something we could not hear. Her eyes would suddenly turn to the upper left, then her pupils would widen, and she would freeze for a few seconds.

“It’s talking,” she said suddenly once, her voice very soft. “It’s telling me things.”

“What things?”

Emma did not answer. She only shook her head.

CHAPTER 3. EMMA IS DISAPPEARING

Over the next few hours, her skin became pale, and her lips turned gray like cement. She began to look down at her hands, then up at us, with something in her eyes that was hard to explain—not fear, but more like accepting her fate. I had seen that look once before, on the face of a suicide in Level 11.

“I’m disappearing,” she finally said.

That night—if this level had night, the lights only dimmed a little—Emma sat at the base of the wall, hugging her knees, and told us in a very calm voice that she could feel her body fading bit by bit. It was not an illusion, not psychological suggestion. She rolled up her sleeve to show us. The skin on her arm had become half-transparent. The outlines of her blood vessels and bones showed through dimly, like a photo soaked in water.

“I’m not hurt,” she said. “But I just know that I’m about to be gone.”

“What are you talking about?” K crouched down and grabbed her shoulders. “You’re fine. You’re just being affected by this level—”

“K.” Emma looked up at him. Her eyes suddenly became very clear. “Do you believe me?”

“Of course I believe you.”

“Then remember what I say.” Her voice became very soft, so soft that I had to move closer to hear. “No matter what happens later, no matter what this hell tells you, it’s not true.”

K’s hands were shaking.

Emma disappeared the next day.

There was no process. She was just sitting there, leaning against the wall, and then she was not there. Her clothes were still there. Her equipment was still there. Her water bottle still stood on the ground. In the air remained some very faint vibration, like the echo after wings beat, and it faded in less than a second.

I stood there, my mind blank. K crouched down and put away Emma’s equipment one piece at a time, moving very slowly. He tightened her water bottle, folded her map, and put her dagger back into its sheath.

“She...” I started, but I did not know how to continue.

“She’s dead,” K said. His voice was flat, so flat that it was wrong.

I nodded.

CHAPTER 4. TWO STEPS AWAY

Then the sentence came.

It came without warning, like a needle entering from the back of my head, soft and exact. The voice was my own voice, but not mine. It did not say “You killed her.” It said something simpler.

“You could have pulled her back.”

I froze. I turned to look at K, but he was looking down, sorting Emma’s things, not looking at me. The sentence sounded again, clearer this time, as if someone were speaking close to my ear.

“You stood two steps away. You watched her disappear. You did nothing.”

“I didn’t—” I opened my mouth to argue, but argue with whom? Argue about what?

K finally looked up. He looked into my eyes, was silent for a few seconds, and then said something that made my back go cold.

“What are you thinking?” he asked.

“Nothing.”

“You’re thinking about whether I killed her.”

“I wasn’t—”

“You are.” K stood up and walked over to me. He was a head taller than me. Standing there against the light, his face was completely hidden in shadow. “From the moment she disappeared, you’ve been looking at me. You think I can’t tell?”

My stomach tightened sharply. A very strong feeling of nausea rose up. It was not physical. It was a thick, sticky guilt seeping out from between my bones. I killed her. The thought drilled in like a parasite and began to lay eggs in my brain.

No. I didn’t. I did nothing.

You did nothing, but you could have done something. You watched her. You stood two steps away. You could have grabbed her.

I closed my eyes and tried to calm down. But when I closed my eyes, I saw Emma’s face, gray and half-transparent, looking in my direction, her lips moving slightly.

“Why didn’t you save me?”

CHAPTER 5. THE VOICE IN THE CRACK

For the next few hours—or days, I couldn't tell—K and I did not say a word to each other. He walked three steps in front of me and never looked back. I walked behind him, staring at his back, my mind full of some unclear mixture of hostility and fear. The voice did not stop.At every turn it repeated the same sentence, only the wording slowly changed.

"You killed her."

"It was you."

I began to understand the three lines in that notebook.

K suddenly stopped. I almost ran into his back.

"What's wrong?"

He did not answer. His shoulders were trembling slightly, and his fists were clenched tight. After a long time, he turned around. There was an expression on his face that I had never seen before—like a mask cracking open, and what showed underneath was wet and red.

I stared at him.

"I can hear that voice too." K's voice became hoarse. "It says I killed her. It says I pushed Emma."

"You didn't—"

"I know I didn't!" he suddenly shouted. His voice hit the empty hallway and echoed. "But I can't prove it! What did you see? Did you see me push her?"

I saw nothing. Emma just disappeared. But K was looking at me with a kind of almost begging desire in his eyes—he wanted me to say, "You did nothing." But the voice in my head was also shouting the opposite. It said: It was him. He's lying. He's covering it up.

"You think it was me too." K's expression changed.

I said nothing.

From that moment on, something was added between K and me. It could not be seen or touched, but it was like a transparent wall, separating us on two sides of the hallway. We were still traveling together, but it was not traveling together anymore. It was one person escorting another, and both of them were prisoners.

K began to talk to himself. Sometimes he argued in a low voice, as if speaking to an invisible person. Sometimes he repeated "I didn't, I didn't, I didn't," like chanting. His eyes became more and more scattered. His pupils would suddenly widen, then shrink back. Once, while walking, he suddenly stopped, stared at the tiles on the wall for a long time, and then reached out to pick at the bent seam until his fingernails bled.

CHAPTER 6. THE JUDGMENT

We found a relatively open space. It looked like a mirror of some level's lobby. A huge crystal chandelier hung overhead, but the light was dim. It flickered sometimes, making a hum like a throat being choked. The floor was covered with marble-patterned tiles. On both sides of the hall stood rows of columns. Each column had complex carvings—they looked like some kind of bird totem, wings spread, beak pointing down, in a diving pose.

K sat under one column, holding his head, his shoulders shaking.

"We should talk," I said.

"Talk about what?" He looked up, his eyes red. "About how you watched Emma die, or about how I pushed her?"

"I didn't say you pushed her—"

"But you thought it." K stared at me. "You think I don't know what you're thinking?"

I was silent. Because what he said was true.

"We're both being controlled by this thing," I said. "This level has mental hazards. Those voices aren't real—"

"Then why are you looking at me?" K cut me off.

I could not answer.

"Listen to me." K suddenly moved closer and lowered his voice. "This thing—this level, these voices—it needs a result. It keeps pushing us to blame each other. Do you hear it? It wants one of us to say, 'I did it.'"

"So what?"

"So if I say it." K looked into my eyes. "If I admit that I killed Emma, will it let you go?"

"What are you talking about—"

"Answer me."

I looked at him. There was a strange clarity in his eyes, as if all the earlier confusion had been an act. But the next second, his eyes went scattered again, and the corner of his mouth twitched.

"I killed her," he said.

"K."

He turned his head to look at me. His eyes had completely lost focus.

"You didn't—"

"Enough!" He cut me off, and his eyes suddenly focused again, staring at my face. "You need me to confess. You need someone to say 'I did it,' and then you can forgive yourself."

He was right. That was the most terrifying part.

K took the notebook out of his backpack, turned to the last few pages, and handed it to me. There was one more line on it, written crookedly.

K looked into my eyes and said, "I'll do it. Then you can leave."

I did not move.

His voice began to shake. "Don't you want to leave? Just say one sentence—just say 'You killed her'—and it will be done. I won't blame you. I chose this myself."

The crystal chandelier suddenly lit up. The sharp white light shone down, and K's face under the light was as pale as paper. He sat under the column with his arms around his knees, curled up like a prisoner waiting for a sentence.

I opened my mouth. But before I made a sound, the corner of K's mouth curved. It was a very small curve, gone very quickly.

He said, "Thank you." Then he was not there.

CHAPTER 7. THE EXIT

It was exactly the same way Emma disappeared. No process, no sound. Clothes fell to the ground. Equipment lay in place. The person was gone. In the air appeared that very faint wing vibration again. This time it lasted longer. I even felt the airflow brush my face.

I crouched down and looked at the pile of things he had left. A water bottle, a notebook, a dagger that had never been used, and several neatly folded maps.

The voice came again.

This time it did not say who killed whom. It only asked a question.

“Are you willing to admit it now?”

I sat on the floor under the crystal chandelier, with two piles of equipment and two sets of clothes no one was wearing beside me. The light was still flickering. From deep in the hallway came a very distant sound of wings flapping.

I opened the notebook K had left. On the last page, below those lines, there was one more line. The ink was wet.

“I killed someone too.”

I stared at that line for a long time. Then I wrote a sentence below it. As the pen tip crossed the paper, I heard my own voice in my head say, “This isn’t real.” But my hand did not stop.

“I killed someone.”

I closed the notebook and put it between the two piles of equipment. Then I stood up and kept walking.

I did not look back.

A door appeared at the end of the hallway. I pushed it open. Inside was a blinding white light.

I stepped in.

CHAPTER 8. ALWAYS THERE

When I woke up, I was lying on a white bed. The ceiling was white, the walls were white, and the light was steady, warm yellow, not flickering. An IV tube was in the back of my hand.

A person in a white coat sat by the bed. He looked at me with a calm expression.

“You’re awake. Welcome to Base Alpha.”

I opened my mouth, but my throat was too dry to make a sound.

“You were found in Level C-[redacted],” he said. “Alone. That level only allows three or more people to no-clip into it at the same time, so we were all surprised when we found you.”

“The other two people...” My voice was hoarse.

“What other two people?”

I looked at him. His expression was sincere. He was not lying.

“What are you asking about?” he asked again. “According to the records, you no-clipped in alone. That level cannot be left until its abnormal effect ends, so we guess you were inside for a long time. You look much better now. Do you remember anything?”

“I...”

“You kept saying ‘I killed her.’”

I closed my eyes.

I saw Emma’s face, gray and half-transparent. I saw K curled up under the column. I saw the notebook, the wet ink on the last page.

“I don’t remember anything,” I said.

The person in the white coat nodded and wrote something in his notebook. Then he stood up and walked to the door.

“Rest well,” he said. “You’ll get better.”

The door closed. I lay on the white bed, staring at the white ceiling. The warm yellow light was very steady and did not flicker at all.

But I heard it.

The sound of wings flapping. Very far, very soft, like some bird had been following me flying.

All along.

Does English More Advanced Than Chinese?

Is Chinese the most advanced language in the world? And is English a shitty code that adds 4,000 new words every year?

In the Kalahari Desert in southern Africa, in the area of Botswana and Namibia, there is a Khoisan language called !Xóõ.

Yes, the African indigenous language with those magical sounds ʘ, ǀ, ǁ, !, ǂ.

ʘ: bilabial click (similar to a kissing sound)

ǀ: dental click (similar to the urging sound “tsk”)

ǁ: alveolar lateral click (similar to a sound used to urge a horse)

!: alveolar click (similar to a cork-popping sound)

ǂ: palatal click

Those sucking and inhaling sounds just now are called clicks.

But there are now fewer than 4,000 native speakers of this !Xóõ language in the world.

Can you imagine? In this !Xóõ language, there isn’t even a separate word for “shoe.” So would you say that our profound Chinese, and English, the most widely used language in the world, are more advanced compared with this !Xóõ language?

Don’t rush to a conclusion yet. Let me find two words in !Xóõ for you, such as !gãĩ and ǀq’ òò. For these two words, neither Chinese nor English has a single word that can precisely translate them.

Among them, !gãĩ has to be described in English as “bitter saline spring in desert.” !gãĩ is a salt lick for wild animals. Large wild animals such as antelopes and wildebeests need to lick this !gãĩ to replenish sodium and minerals. This kind of !gãĩ, an important anchor for group migration and a place crucial to the group’s survival, was given its own independent word in !Xóõ.

The other word, ǀq’ òò, has to be described in English as “spoor of an injured animal.” ǀq’ òò specifically refers to the series of deformed footprints left by an injured animal. Indigenous hunting first uses poison arrows to shoot; the arrow poison does not kill the animal immediately. After being hit by a poisoned arrow, the prey usually takes several hours or even days to die from the poison. The hunter needs to track it for dozens of kilometers before finally obtaining the prey’s meat. If the hunter cannot recognize this special prey’s footprints, then either the prey is lost, or he has run for dozens of kilometers over several days and nights for nothing. The final result is that the tribe goes hungry or even starves to death. The word ǀq’ òò is tied to the hunter’s hunting success and the tribe’s lives, so !Xóõ also gave it an independent word. The native environments of Chinese and English were not desert hunting civilizations, so naturally they do not have such precise hunting words as !gãĩ and ǀq’ òò.

So now, in the eyes of native Chinese and English speakers, !Xóõ doesn’t even have a separate word for “shoe,” so it is obviously a “primitive language.” But in the eyes of native !Xóõ speakers, Chinese and English don’t even have words for !gãĩ and ǀq’ òò, so they are “primitive languages” that cannot even guarantee basic hunting and survival.

So do you understand now? There is absolutely no such thing as an absolute high or low among languages! Every language is born from the culture, customs, and living environment of its native speakers. When any two languages are compared, there will be many, many words that cannot be precisely translated into each other. The vocabulary of language A often "packages" A's civilization together with its words. When language B "unpacks" language A, the result is often a phrase or a long sentence, or even a long passage, rather than a single precise word. This situation is called a lexical gap, that is, a word or concept that exists in one language but has no direct equivalent in another.

For example, "星期八." Some people say, "Chinese can say '星期八' but English can't, so we win." But is English really unable to describe and express "星期八"? Obviously not. English simply lacks a single word that precisely translates Chinese's "星期八," but English can describe it with the phrase "the eighth day of a week." This is a typical case of lexical gap. Using "星期八" to show that English is inferior to Chinese is completely untenable logically. Moreover, "week" was originally introduced to China from the West. The week and the seven days in a week are words and concepts already "packaged" by English. In the process of unpacking, Chinese replaced the Western concept of the seven luminaries' days with the ordinal concept 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, and then, according to its own replaced ordinal concept, created "星期八," and finally turned around and said that English cannot say "星期八," thereby showing that English is inferior to Chinese. To put it plainly, this is the absurd logic of using someone else's "original package," first "unpacking" it, then "replacing" it, and then turning around and calling the other's "original package" inferior.

By this, for English words like Humor, Sofa, Logic, and Hysteria, Chinese all has lexical gaps and cannot say them, so they need to be transliterated as "幽默(yōumò)," "沙发(shāfā)," "逻辑(luójí)," and "歇斯底里(xiēsīdǐlǐ)." Does this show that English is more advanced than Chinese? Obviously not.

Everyone should know that lexical gaps cannot judge the superiority or inferiority of languages. No language is inherently primitive. What is truly primitive is the mentality of needing to win in everything, bred by impoverished cognition, narrow-mindedness, and extreme inferiority.

I know many people will still say, "English is indeed not inferior to Chinese, but English is just a 'shit-mountain code.' The Oxford English Dictionary adds more than 4,000 new English words every year. Doesn't that prove the problem?" I want to ask those who say this: Have you really looked into how many words the Oxford English Dictionary adds each year? Have you really looked into which words are added? Or are you just echoing what clickbait accounts say?

Let me tell you. Taking 2025 as an example, the Oxford English Dictionary added about 1,500 new words. The new words mainly fall into five categories:

The first category is compounds, accounting for about 40%, such as “binge-read.” Binge is an old word, meaning a short period of time when sb does too much of a particular activity. Read is also an old word. So binge-read is a new word formed by combining old words, meaning to read for intensive or extended periods.

The second category is derivatives formed from roots and affixes, accounting for about 30%. For example, “bingeable” is a derivative formed from the old word binge plus the old root able, meaning engaging enough to encourage the watching of multiple episodes over a short period of time.

The third category is abbreviations, accounting for about 13%, such as “NEET”, whose full form is *Not in Education, Employment or Training*. All of these are old words.

The fourth category is loanwords, accounting for about 17%, such as “ekiden”, borrowed from the Japanese “駅伝.” Ekiden means a Japanese long-distance relay race where runners complete sequential stages and pass a sash to the next runner.

Only the fifth category consists of completely new words formed from entirely new letter combinations, and its proportion is 0%

That is to say, in modern English there are almost no newly added words that are entirely new letter strings created from zero. Of course, if you don’t understand English at all, then the four types of new words above will also look to you like “newly created letter sequence strings.”

I also know that some people will definitely say, “I saw those ‘super-long’ English words in clickbait accounts, like ‘pneumonoultramicroscopicsilicovolcanoconiosis’ and ‘TITIN.’” There will also definitely be people who say, “Clickbait accounts often say that the English words for pig, cow, and sheep and the words for pork, beef, and mutton are not from the same set.”

For these things you learned from clickbait accounts, you can think for yourselves: apart from academic research and formal documents, are those super-long words ever used in daily life? In addition, the issue that the words for “pig, cow, sheep” and “pork, beef, mutton” are not from the same set is mainly because the sources of English are very complex, for example from Old Germanic, Old English, Old Norse, Old French, Greek, Latin, etc. Modern English also constantly borrows words. This diversity makes English structurally very complex.

Of course you can call any foreign language “shitty code,” but shouldn’t you first master at least a thousand or eight hundred words of that foreign language, and at least first understand its word-formation rules?

So there is no primitive language. Every language has its unique meaning in its environment of use.

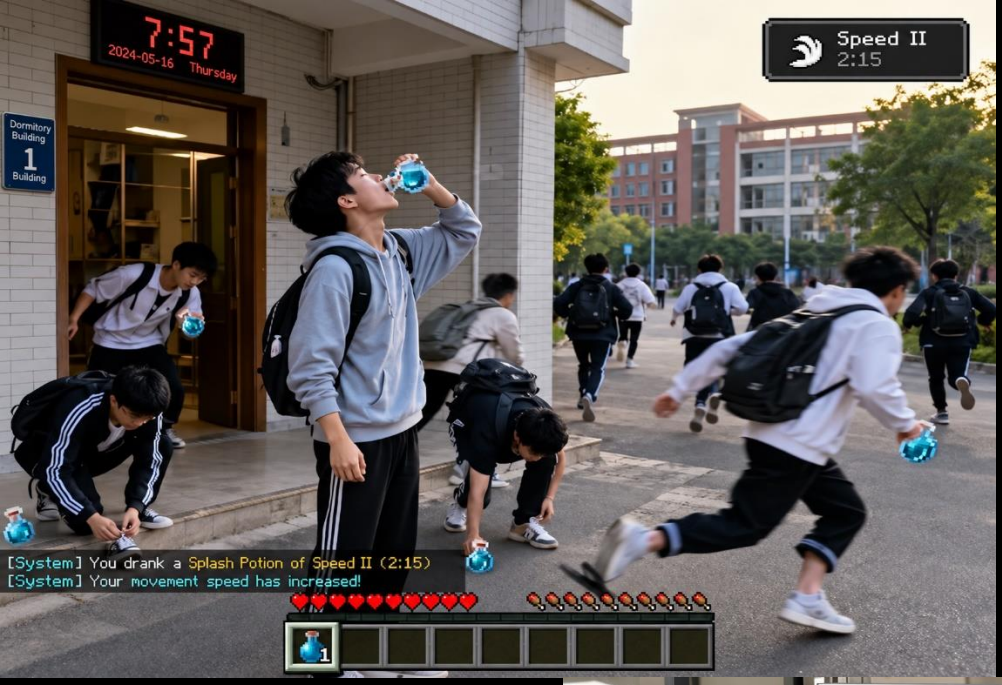


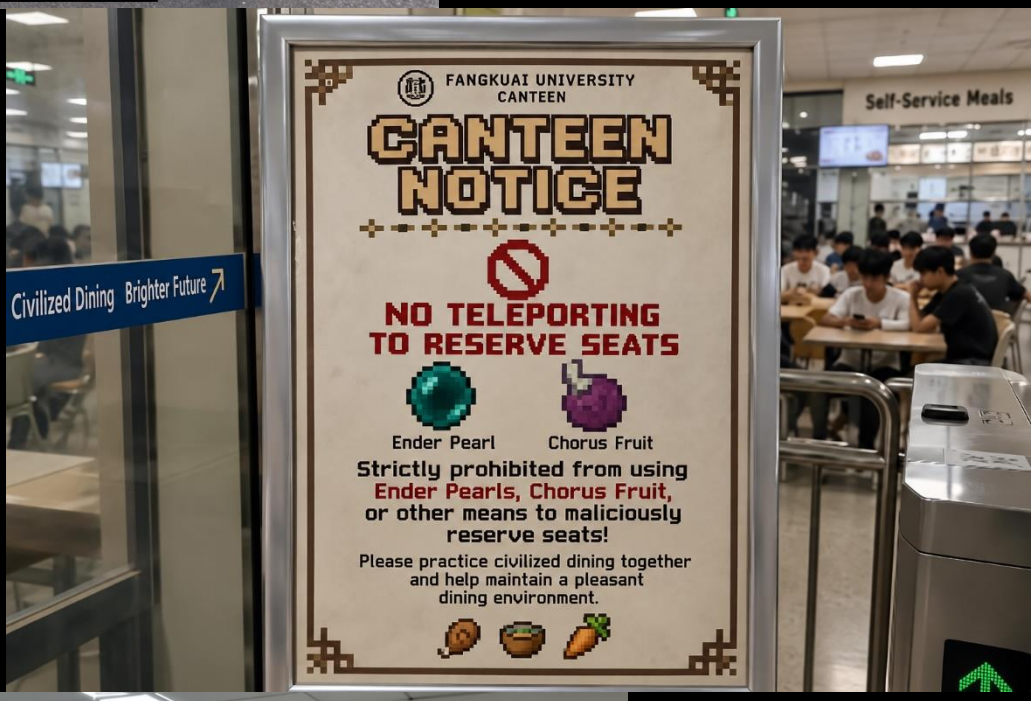
There Is Always a World Like This

Recently, photos like this have become popular online: various everyday scenes generated by AI, but the difference is that the features from Minecraft (such as tool or weapon effects, potion effects) begin to take effect in this world.

From this, we can see what the features of Minecraft look like in real, actual life. For those Minecraft players, this is truly like “finding a treasure.” And the author who posted this set of pictures often titles this work “There Is Always a World Like This,” making people think and yearn. Perhaps in the multiverse outside our universe, there really is such a universe.




7:57
2024-05-16 Thursday
Dormitory Building 1 Building
Speed II
2:15
[System] You drank a Splash Potion of Speed II (2:15)
[System] Your movement speed has increased!


Civilized Dining Brighter Future
FANGKUAI UNIVERSITY CANTEEN
CANTEEN NOTICE
NO TELEPORTING TO RESERVE SEATS
Ender Pearl
Chorus Fruit
Strictly prohibited from using Ender Pearls, Chorus Fruit, or other means to maliciously reserve seats!
Please practice civilized dining together and help maintain a pleasant dining environment.
Self-Service Meals


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— DEDICATED SERVICE · A BRIGHTER WORLD —
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FINANCE IS THE LIFELINE OF THE UNIVERSITY
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3 ENSURE FUND SAFETY
4 IMPROVE SERVICE QUALITY
5 SUPPORT UNIVERSITY DEVELOPMENT
EVERY CONTRIBUTION MAKES A BRIGHTER TOMORROW
PAINECRAFT
A BLOCKY WORLD WITH ENDLESS POSSIBILITIES
MINECRAFT
A BLOCKY WORLD WITH ENDLESS POSSIBILITIES
SALARY STAFF 4.87 kg
SALARY STAFF 4.15 kg
SALARY STAFF 5.08 kg
5.32 kg
SALARY DISBURSEMENT
— YOUR HARD WORK BUILDS A BRIGHTER WORLD —
SALARY DISTRIBUTION
BUILDING A BRIGHTER WORLD TOGETHER
PAYROLL DOCUMENTS
64



~~Frowning Husks~~ Partypoopers =)

I remember how that damned creature cornered me, biting me with the sharp mouth on one of its arms. I wasn't able to scream, cry or physically react. Blue, leathery skin began painfully replacing my flesh until I could no longer feel my muscles. All I could do was curse in my mind, and curse at the world. To my horror, my mind retained its humanity, and I saw myself as the monster I became, a reflection that shouldn't have been my own. I cursed at myself for having survived the transformation while others didn't. The others had the chance of embracing mindless monstrosity, at least at peace with their new purpose and effectively dying as the people they were with dignity. Why did I end up different? What went wrong?

My skin was rubbery and disgusting and I felt compressed by it, as if my old body was turning into remains. Nothing I attempted managed to put a stop to it.

I had to learn everything back from scratch. How to walk with my oversized legs, how to communicate with my mind rather than a mouth, how to recognize and accept myself...

It was difficult, but I pushed through thanks to others who were in my same situation. We met over time, all of us confused and scared. We decided to stick together out of survival, only to start treating each other like a family —our last string that kept us sane.

Even if I knew deep in my heart I was still human, I no longer felt like one. I struggled to believe in that humanity, as every inch of my now monstrous body was tormenting me into forgetting who I was. The inability to hold a pen properly or to cook without pathetically dropping the things I'm holding is one of the most agonizing experiences I had to endure. The fact that I'll never be able to see my expressions in the mirror or even sing a song again is further salt in my wound.

The Backrooms are truly a vile realm, but I will not let it destroy me, even in this new form... I am loved. I have people who want me to keep going and I need to push through for them and for those in my same condition. This is why I'm fighting with all my might to be heard, to have our voices heard by others. I want everyone to know we are still... us, even if this condition is debilitating. Even if sometimes my mind screams at me to escape from this leather skin prison and reach my wife up above. Even if we now are "Frowning Husks".

"Greetings, and welcome to Base Alpha. Pencils and a notebook have been supplied to you in light of this meeting. You may use those for communication, Mr. Reginald, but please maintain a distance between the two of us."

Thank you, Ms. Molly. I'm grateful that you decided to listen to my request and allowed me to come here. What do you think about my proposal, then?

“Writing an article to ease the tension around you all is a great proposal. However, as you may know, we’d have to classify you as entities. Not to mention that we’d need to respect a certain protocol regarding what you choose to write. We will supply you with a computer, but at the same time we will keep a close eye on the writing progress.”

Is it necessary for us to be classified as entities? A formal article wasn’t in the plans, especially because it may not share our message as greatly as we wanted it to. Wouldn’t it be fit to classify this as a phenomenon or another category?

“Mr. Reginald, the others were very clear about the precautions we have to take. Something too personal will lead wanderers to grow far too trusting. Regardless of what you were in the past, what you are now fits the classification of entities. We classify any being as such even if they are almost like human beings. You are aware of the concerns regarding the nature of your proposal, aren’t you?”

This isn’t a ploy, Ms. Molly. Our safety and dignity is on the line. We are targets of entity extermination groups and are treated exactly like Partygoers. We are not trying to harm anyone, and this isn’t a tactic set up by them to hurt more people. We just want to live in peace and be part of humanity again, like we deserve. We want to be treated normally.

“Here is the thing, Mr. Reginald. While I can assure in some way or another that you and others like you are not a threat, that does not leave the possibility that those creatures won’t decide to use this newfound discovery to their advantage. They are intelligent and cunning entities who have caused a lot of deaths and problems. What makes you think that they won’t adapt accordingly to this situation and not stop carving their mouths as a whole so that you both will be completely unrecognizable from the other? As soon as people begin growing fond of you all, their safety will be on the line. There is nothing we can do regarding how other groups approach the situation aside from trying to monitor you.”

“We are charitable, Mr. Reginald. But the safety of people is our responsibility.”

Are we not people?

“Not the same as us, no. Your hearts and memories may be those of a human, but your physiology isn’t human. Your physiology is those of beasts who are still capable of transforming others, regardless if you are not mentally like them. Not all transformed people are kind. One of them may not have a good nature and they can attack and transform unsuspecting wanderers who were not careful or distrusting enough. This isn’t a matter of being people, but it’s a matter of the danger posed by malicious transformed people. All of you are unpredictable, regardless of what is said and shown and you will be regarded as such whether you like it or not.”

I understand. But at the very least, all we ask is to be able to affirm that we are not monsters.

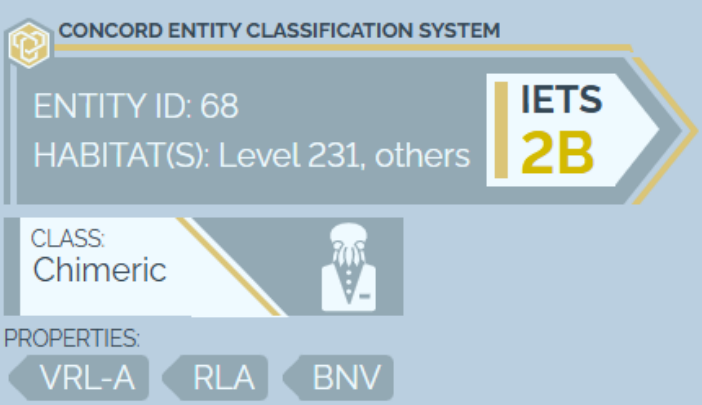
“I’ll take that into account. Do you understand our terms?”

I do.

“Very well then.”

This article was posted under the supervision of the M.E.G. and is deemed not malicious or dangerous. Carefulness is still recommended when approaching these entities.

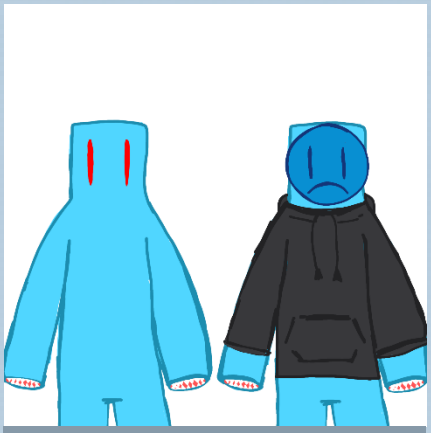
- Agent Molly, M.E.G.



"A human being is not recognized by their exterior, but by their mannerisms, their likes, and their heart. A human will always be one, so as long as they maintain the essence of their identity."

Who are we?

We are human beings that have been transformed by Partygoers. However, instead of turning into one of them, we became defective instances of them. While blue coloured Partygoers do exist, in rare instances, we are not the same as them. Our transformation is deemed incomplete and thus we are marked as a sub-species of the regular Partygoers. The M.E.G. calls us Frowning Husks, or simply Entity 68.



A close up drawing on how we typically look like.

Our defective nature comes from the incomplete mental degradation that all transformed humans endure. Our bodies were all successfully changed, but the transformation seemingly came to a halt when it began affecting the mind.

While we don't know the reason on why this could have happened, we theorize it must be due to the incomplete development of the Phobic Centipede within our bodies and the incomplete mental connection to Partygoer Zero. The Phobic Centipede and Partygoer Zero both influence the transformed host's behaviours inside a regular Partygoer, but we are not influenced by either. That also means we are not influenced into carving mouths onto our faces in order to imitate the Centipede itself and other behaviours, such as engaging in parties.

Due to the underdeveloped Phobic Centipede, we are incapable of manifesting full balloons like newly created Partygoers do. We are also unable to use quick short-range telepathy between each-other. In order to communicate, we require a lot of effort and time.

We don't know why our transformation had a different outcome than others, as we deem it impossible to research its causes. What most of us theorize is that it had to do with biological anomalies that solely affected blue variant partygoers, which means they are more unstable than the others and more prone to fail a complete transformation upon biting a victim. However, we will never receive a confirmation regarding the truth.

What do we look like?

We all resemble blue Partygoers that lack a carved smile. All of us prefer to wear pieces of clothing that we enjoy, such as dresses or hoodies and wear accessories to better communicate our identity and personality. What we all share is a blue mask with a frowning face that the great majority of us wear, which we use to separate ourselves from regular Partygoers, but also as a provocation against them. We find their actions to be repulsive and our frowning masks symbolize the opposite of their permanent, manipulative smiles. These are the only ways for us to appear different, as our biology and regular appearance is almost the exact same as those of our malicious peers. Always remember, Frowning Husks are only true ones if they lack a carved smile. Partygoers are unpredictable and could attempt to mimic us to lure people to their demise, so please exercise caution.

How do we act?

Unlike Partygoers, we don't instinctually wish to transform others into Frowning Husks, as we still retain our morals and our reason. We don't share the same views between each other, which means that some of us may be malicious, like any human beings can be.

We tend to avoid traveling in groups, as to not make people think we are blue Partygoers. We prefer to wander in solitude, while still reuniting in levels populated by a great majority of us. We like to help each other whenever it's needed. Some of us may be more reserved than others, but we all are trying our hardest to be helpful and positive.

Most of us wish to aid in fending off the Partygoers, as they harm innocent people and represent an everlasting threat to humanity in the Backrooms. We condemn their leader and all instances of them. We pray all to understand this and not believe Partygoer misbeliefs, so as to allow us to exist. Whatever may happen, we will be ready to fight Partygoers at any moment of our lives.

Reginald stepped away from his assigned M.E.G. computer. He found typing on the keyboard to be extremely difficult with his transformed hands, but he was able to push through and succeed at the very least. It was already a courtesy for the M.E.G. to allow them to borrow one in order to write this article, so he couldn't exactly complain. Regardless, it felt humiliating to speak of himself and his companions in such a formal, cold way. He wanted to put words on the pain of being trapped in a prison of flesh. He wanted to plead humans to speak to him and the others. He wanted humanity to call them by their names and not by a species. Yet he was bound by terms and visible weariness from others, unable to speak, unable to scream.

He hoped that this article would ease the aggressivity and fear towards him and other transformed people, even if it wouldn't do so in the way he wanted. He didn't blame anyone for doubting him or his companions, but he hoped the circumstances would eventually change in their favour; that one day they'd be heard like a human would be, even if that possibility felt unreachable. All he could do was behave like a beaten stray dog that could only plead to receive empathy like a wounded man would, or like a bug about to be squished. Its only sin was to exist in a shared space.

With an internal sigh, after a few minutes of silence, he went to report what he wrote to the others.

Level 231 was joyful as usual. The laughter of the children inhabiting it made him feel much more at ease. He saw Nina and Jonas playing with Emily. They clung to her long blue limbs and climbed on her strong shoulders. Even if she couldn't properly express it, she was happy to spend time with them. He saw all the others spending their time doing their favourite activities. Matthew was trying to clumsily cut a few vegetables under the supervision of Ms. Cadence, Jen was reading one of the many newspapers she found with Sarah, and all the others were entertaining themselves with crafting some nice decorations. Their mutation made it difficult to do all these things normally, but it was no longer as big of a problem as it was before.

"Mister Reginald! Come check what we are drawing!" Alana called him from one of the tables. The other kids had joined her in a group and they were all doodling together. With a bit of difficulty, he moved closer and attempted to find a comfortable position.

"*What are you making?*" He wrote on his notebook to communicate, curious as to why the children called him in such a hurry. Humbert giggled, he was barely unable to contain himself from revealing the surprise. "Humbert! You're gonna give away the secret if you act like that!" Sarah scolded him before returning to her project. Humbert became as quiet as a mouse and added the finishing touches. Once complete, Jonas showed their masterpiece to Reginald.



“It’s us! Miss Emily helped us draw you. She’s so talented!” Jonas said in a cheerful tone. All the children embraced him quite tightly. “You’re the coolest, Mr Reginald. We wanted to make you a gift since you’re working so hard to help!” They all tried to say in unison. Reginald almost felt ghost tears dripping from his carved eyes. He embraced the children and held them so close. Despite everything, they were always the ones reminding him of his humanity. These children were his family, treating him exactly how he desired to be treated, like he was one of them.

“*Thank you, children.*” He scrambled to write his gratitude. The others soon joined the hug when they noticed the affection pile. “You deserve it Reggie! You work like hell to spread our voices!” Jen communicated to him through some effort. The embrace felt like an eternity, reminding him of the same way his wife and children would hug him when he returned from work. His heart ached as he prayed that this would last a bit longer. This was a firm reminder of his purpose. He could not afford to let them all down. He could not let the loss of his dignity as a human tear him apart.

Ashley... Mary... and my darling Rebecca up there in heaven... I’ll continue pushing through like you’d want me to... For your sake and theirs.

Psychology Terms Introduction

Chapter 1: Cognitive Biases and Decision-Making Fallacies

1. Cognitive Dissonance

What it is: When your behavior and your beliefs are inconsistent, you feel really uncomfortable, so you can't help but find a reason for yourself to feel better.

Example: You know smoking is harmful to your health, but you still smoke. To keep yourself from feeling too anxious, you say, "My grandpa smoked his whole life and lived to 90," using this reason to balance the inner conflict.

2. Broken Windows Effect

What it is: If there's a broken window somewhere that nobody fixes, soon more windows will be broken. If small disorder in the environment isn't stopped in time, it will spread into bigger problems.

Example: If there's a pile of garbage on a street that nobody cleans up, in a few days more garbage will pile up; but if the street is always clean, people actually feel embarrassed to litter.

3. Bystander Effect

What it is: When many people are present, each person thinks "someone else will help," and as a result, nobody acts. The more people there are, the more responsibility is diffused.

Example: Someone suddenly faints on the subway. If there are only two or three people in the car, they'll probably immediately step forward to help; but if the car is packed with people, everyone just looks at each other and nobody moves.

4. Self-Fulfilling Prophecy

What it is: Your expectations about something affect your behavior, and your behavior ultimately makes the original expectation come true.

Example: You think you'll definitely do poorly on an exam, so you don't study seriously, and you really do fail—it's not that your "prophecy" was accurate, but that your negative expectation led to negative behavior.

5. Stockholm Syndrome

What it is: People who are kidnapped or controlled instead develop emotional dependence, sympathy, or even help their captors. Because in extreme fear and helplessness, a tiny bit of "kindness" from the captor gets magnified into a lifeline.

Example: A hostage is held by a robber for a few days. The robber gives her a sip of water, and she feels the robber "isn't actually a bad person," and eventually even speaks up for the robber during a police rescue.

6. Endowment Effect

What it is: Once something becomes "mine," you overvalue it. Merely owning something makes you feel it's more valuable.

Example: You have an old cup you've used for two years. Someone offers 20 yuan for it and you think it's too cheap and can't bear to sell; but if someone asked you to spend 20 yuan to buy an identical old cup, you'd definitely think it's not worth it.

7. Oedipus Complex

What it is: A concept proposed by *Freud*, referring to boys around ages 3-6 developing attachment and possessiveness toward their mother, while feeling jealousy and hostility toward their father. This is a developmental stage that most people naturally pass through.

Example: A four- or five-year-old boy sees his dad hugging his mom, runs over to push his dad away, saying "Mom is mine," and also says "When I grow up I want to marry Mom"—this is a typical manifestation of the Oedipus complex, a normal developmental stage.

> *Oedipus: A tragic figure in Greek mythology, son of King Laius of Thebes and Queen Jocasta. When Oedipus was born, the Oracle of Delphi prophesied that he would kill his father and marry his mother. To prevent the prophecy from coming true, his parents abandoned him, but he was rescued by a shepherd and raised by King Polybus of Corinth. As an adult, to escape the prophecy, he left Corinth, accidentally killed his biological father Laius on the way, and then married his own mother Jocasta.*

8. Rationalization

What it is: Finding a seemingly reasonable explanation for your behavior to cover up the real motive and protect your self-esteem.

Example: You did poorly on an exam, and you say "The questions were too obscure, it wasn't what we studied," rather than admitting "I didn't study enough"—this is rationalization, using a dignified reason to protect self-esteem.

9. Repression

What it is: Actively and unconsciously pushing thoughts, memories, or impulses that are too painful or anxiety-provoking into the unconscious, keeping them from entering consciousness.

Example: A person who experienced severe abuse in childhood completely doesn't remember this experience as an adult, as if it never happened—this is repression, the brain sealing away memories that are too painful.

> *"I don't blame you at all, though."*
>
> *I thought he was going to say it, and I would immediately be forgiven, and my heart would be at ease from then on. "Did something like that happen?" he said with a surprised smile, as if listening to someone else's story. He remembered nothing.*
>
> *—Lu Xun, "The Kite"*

10. Displacement (Kick-the-Cat Effect)

What it is: Transferring emotions (usually anger) toward one target onto another safer, weaker target. Because venting directly at the original target is too dangerous.

Example: Dad gets scolded by his boss at work, doesn't dare talk back to the boss, comes home and sees his child hasn't finished homework, and furiously scolds the child—anger is displaced onto the safer child.

11. Fixation

What it is: Getting stuck at a certain stage of psychological development because needs were either unmet or over-gratified at that stage, and retaining that stage's behavioral patterns into adulthood.

Example: A person whose oral stage needs weren't sufficiently met in childhood (e.g., weaned too early) becomes especially fond of snacks, smoking, and nail-biting as an adult—these are all oral-related behaviors, manifestations of fixation at the oral stage.

12. Splitting

What it is: Seeing people and things as "all good" or "all bad," unable to accept that a person has both good and bad sides. This is a relatively primitive defense mechanism, commonly seen in borderline personality.

Example: When a person first meets a friend, they think the other is perfect and the best person in the world; but once the other does something disappointing, they immediately think this person is worthless and a jerk—unable to integrate "good" and "bad" in the same person.

Chapter 3: Attachment, Self, and Social Cognition

13. Attachment Styles (Secure/Anxious/Avoidant)

What it is: The pattern of emotional bonding formed with primary caregivers (usually the mother) in infancy, which affects behavior in intimate relationships later in life. Mainly divided into three types: secure (can trust others and be independent), anxious (fears abandonment, needs constant reassurance of love), avoidant (fears intimacy, habitually independent, avoids emotional expression).

Example: Partner hasn't replied to a message for half a day—a secure person thinks "He's probably busy" and goes about their day; an anxious person becomes anxious and frantically sends messages and calls; an avoidant person thinks "Whatever, if he doesn't reply, he doesn't reply," and even actively distances themselves.

14. Self-Monitoring

What it is: The degree to which you observe and adjust your behavior, expressions, and speech in social situations. High self-monitors are very good at "reading the room" and adjusting themselves according to the environment; low self-monitors are "how they are is how they are" and don't care much about the occasion.

Example: A high self-monitor behaves seriously and professionally in formal meetings, and can also let loose and have fun at friends' gatherings; a low self-monitor is the same person in every setting, possibly telling inappropriate jokes even in serious meetings.

15. Self-Serving Bias

What it is: People tend to attribute success to their own abilities and effort, and failure to external circumstances and luck. Simply put, "Success is all my credit, failure is all someone else's fault."

Example: When you do well on an exam, you think "It's because I'm smart and worked hard"; when you do poorly, you think "The questions were too obscure, the teacher didn't teach well, I wasn't in a good state that day"—success goes to yourself, failure goes to external factors.

16. Social Facilitation/Inhibition

What it is: When others are present, your performance changes. For simple, well-practiced tasks, the presence of others makes you perform better; for complex, unpracticed tasks, the presence of others makes you perform worse.

Example: A professional runner runs faster in a competition (with many spectators) than when training alone (simple, well-practiced task, social facilitation); but someone just learning to give a speech becomes more nervous and forgets more words when standing on stage facing many people than when practicing alone (complex, unpracticed task, social inhibition).

17. Social Loafing

What it is: When completing a task together in a group, individuals put in less effort than when completing it alone. Because "we're all doing it together anyway, nobody will notice if I put in less effort."

Example: In group assignments, there are always one or two members who "slack off" and don't do much work, because they think "Someone else is doing it anyway, and the final grade is shared by everyone"—this is social loafing.

18. Compliance

What it is: Agreeing to do something at someone's request. Unlike obedience, compliance isn't because the other person has authority, but because the other person made a request and you feel awkward refusing.

Example: A colleague says "Grab me a coffee, would you?" You don't want to move but still agree; a salesperson says "This product is really perfect for you," you didn't want to buy but feel too embarrassed to refuse and buy it—this is compliance.

Chapter 4: Emotion, Memory, and Learning

19. Mood-Congruent Recall

What it is: When you're in a certain emotional state, you more easily recall things consistent with that emotion. When happy, you easily recall happy things; when sad, you easily recall sad things.

Example: When you're in a good mood, the memories that come up are all "birthdays as a kid were so happy," "that trip was so fun"—pleasant memories; but when you're depressed, what pops into your head are all "I failed that exam," "he hurt me back then"—painful memories.

20. Priming Effect

What it is: Information you've been exposed to before affects how you process related information later. Like "warming up," the previous stimulus activates related concepts in the brain, making subsequent processing faster.

Example: You just saw the word "knife," and next when asked to complete a word with missing letters "kn_," you're very likely to fill in "knife" rather than "know"—because the concept "knife" was just primed.

21. Working Memory

What it is: The ability to temporarily "store" and "process" information in your head while doing something. Its capacity is limited, generally only about 7±2 information units at a time, and if you don't rehearse it repeatedly, it's quickly forgotten.

Example: Someone tells you a phone number, you repeat it in your head a few times, then go to dial. But if someone says a few words to you in between, you might forget the number—because the phone number is stored in working memory and is easily disrupted.

22. Generalization

What it is: In classical conditioning, stimuli similar to the conditioned stimulus can also elicit a similar response. That is, after learning to respond to one stimulus, the response "generalizes" to similar stimuli.

Example: A child was frightened by a white rabbit, and later he's not only afraid of white rabbits, but also white cats, white dogs, even white plush toys—the fear response has generalized to all white fluffy things.

23. Marshmallow Experiment

What it is: A classic experiment by *Stanford University* psychologist *Mischel:* each child is given a marshmallow, and told that if they don't eat it now, they can get two when the adult returns. Then the children's ability to hold out is observed. Follow-up research found that children who could hold out performed better academically and socially as adults.

Example: In the experiment, some children couldn't resist and ate the marshmallow as soon as the adult left; some children used various methods to distract themselves—singing, closing their eyes, turning around—and managed to hold out, finally getting two marshmallows. This experiment demonstrates the importance of delayed gratification ability.

24. Fixed Mindset

What it is: The opposite of growth mindset. People with a fixed mindset believe that abilities and intelligence are innate and unchanging. They fear failure because failure means "I'm not good enough," so they tend to avoid challenges.

Example: A student with a fixed mindset fails a math exam and thinks "I'm just not cut out for math, no matter how hard I try it's useless," and then gives up on math; when facing difficult problems, they're unwilling to try because they're afraid that not being able to solve them proves they're stupid.

Chapter 5: Positive Psychology and Occupational Mental Health

25. Post-Traumatic Growth

What it is: Some people, after experiencing major trauma (such as serious illness, loss of a loved one, disaster), not only aren't defeated but actually achieve positive psychological growth—cherishing life more, being more grateful, having deeper relationships, discovering new possibilities, and having an enhanced sense of self-strength.

Example: A person experiences a serious illness and nearly dies. After recovery, he's completely changed: no longer agonizing over small things, cherishing time with family more, quitting a job he didn't like to do what he truly wants to do—the trauma actually made him live more clearly and meaningfully.

26. Catastrophizing

What it is: Encountering a small thing and thinking of the worst possible outcome, treating a very unlikely disaster as something that will inevitably happen. It's a common form of cognitive distortion.

Example: You do poorly on one exam, and you think "It's over, I failed this exam, I'll definitely do poorly on the college entrance exam too, won't get into a good university, won't find a good job, my whole life is ruined"—from doing poorly on one exam, directly deducing "my whole life is ruined," this is catastrophizing.

27. Exposure Therapy (Systematic Desensitization/Flooding)

What it is: A common method for treating phobias and anxiety disorders. Having the client gradually (systematic desensitization) or suddenly (flooding) face the feared object or situation, repeatedly exposing them in a safe environment until the fear response gradually diminishes and disappears.

Example: A person is afraid of dogs. Systematic desensitization approach: first look at photos of dogs, when not afraid anymore look at videos of dogs, then look at dogs in cages, finally touch a gentle dog—step by step. Flooding approach is directly putting him in a room with many gentle dogs, having him face his greatest fear all at once.

28. Stranger Anxiety

What it is: It's referring to the fear and wariness of strangers that babies begin to show around 6-8 months. When strangers approach or try to hold the baby, the baby cries and hides behind the caregiver. This is a normal manifestation of infant cognitive development and attachment formation, usually peaking at 12-18 months, then gradually diminishing.

Example: A 7-month-old baby used to let anyone hold him. But recently, relatives visited, and when a relative reached out to hold him, he immediately cried, clung tightly to his mother and wouldn't let go, and looked warily at the relative. Mom says "This child used to not be shy with strangers, why is he like this now"—this is stranger anxiety, a normal manifestation of the baby developing to this stage, indicating he can now distinguish familiar people from strangers.

29. Identity Diffusion

What it is: One of the identity statuses, referring to adolescents who neither actively explore various possibilities nor make commitments and choices. They don't have a clear answer to "who am I," have no direction for the future, and are in a state of "confusion, indifference, drifting with the tide."

Example: A senior high school student, uninterested in studying, with no thoughts about the future, just drifting through each day. When asked "What do you want to do in the future," he says "I don't know, just take it one step at a time." He hasn't explored his interests and possibilities, nor made any commitments—this is identity diffusion, with no clear positioning of self and future.

30. Near-Death Experience (Five Stages)

What it is: The five-stage model of dying psychology proposed by *Kübler-Ross*, describing the five psychological stages terminally ill patients typically go through when facing death:

Denial ("This can't be real");

Anger ("Why me? This isn't fair!");

Bargaining ("If I could live a few more years, I'd be willing to...");

Depression ("I'm dying, everything is meaningless");

Acceptance ("I'm ready, facing it peacefully").

This model was later also used to describe psychological reactions after any major loss.

Example: A person is diagnosed with terminal cancer. At first he can't accept it, going everywhere for re-examinations, thinking "It must be a misdiagnosis" (denial). Then he becomes angry, blaming everyone and everything, taking it out on family, "Why did I get this disease of all people" (anger). Then he starts praying, "If I could get better, I'd definitely do more good deeds" (bargaining). Then he falls into depression, silent and withdrawn, uninterested in everything, feeling life is meaningless (depression). Finally, he gradually accepts reality, reconciles with family, arranges his affairs, and peacefully spends his final days (acceptance).

Chapter 6: Sensation, Perception, Attention, and Consciousness

31. Selective Attention

What it is: The ability to consciously focus attention on certain stimuli while ignoring others among numerous external stimuli. Our attentional resources are limited, and we can't process all information simultaneously, so we need to "select" what to focus on and what to ignore.

Example: At a noisy party, with many people talking around you, music playing, glasses clinking, you can focus on chatting with the person in front of you, hearing every word they say clearly, while barely hearing what others nearby are saying—this is selective attention at work, you've "selected" to focus your attention on the conversation in front of you, filtering out other sounds.

32. Inattentional Blindness

What it is: When attention is completely focused on a task, people become blind to clearly visible things that appear in their visual field. Unlike change blindness, inattentional blindness isn't "not seeing a change," but "not seeing that thing exists at all," because attention isn't on it.

Example: The classic "invisible gorilla" experiment: subjects watch a video and count how many times people in white shirts pass a ball. In the middle of the video, a person in a gorilla suit walks into the frame, stops in the middle to beat their chest, then walks out. This whole process lasts several seconds and is very obvious. But results showed about half the subjects completely didn't see the gorilla—because their attention was entirely on counting passes, they were blind to the gorilla. This is inattentional blindness.

33. Visual Cliff Experiment (Depth Perception)

What it is: A classic experiment designed by Gibson and Walk to study infants' depth perception ability. The apparatus is a table where half the surface is solid (shallow side) and the other half is transparent glass with the floor visible below (looking like a cliff). The infant is placed in the middle to see if they'll crawl over the "cliff" side. Results found that most infants over 6 months refuse to crawl over the "cliff," indicating they already have depth perception and can perceive height and danger.

Example: An 8-month-old baby is placed in the middle of the visual cliff apparatus, with the mother beckoning from the "cliff" side. The baby crawls to the edge, looks at the "cliff" below, stops, doesn't dare crawl forward, and even starts crying—he can perceive "it's deep below, very dangerous," indicating depth perception has developed. Younger infants (2-3 months) who can't crawl yet, when placed at the edge of the "cliff," show decreased heart rate, indicating they can also perceive depth differences, just haven't developed fear yet.

34. Sensory Deprivation

What it is: Deliberately reducing or eliminating external sensory stimulation (vision, hearing, touch, etc.), putting a person in a state with almost no sensory input. Sensory deprivation experiments found that prolonged sensory deprivation leads to adverse reactions such as difficulty concentrating, confused thinking, hallucinations, emotional fluctuations, and declined cognitive ability, indicating that moderate sensory stimulation is a necessary condition for maintaining normal psychological function.

Example: The 1954 *McGill University* sensory deprivation experiment in Canada: subjects lay in a soundproof small room, wearing translucent goggles (only seeing diffuse light, no specific shapes), unable to hear sounds, hands wearing cardboard sleeves and cotton gloves (reducing touch). Subjects received $20 per day (a lot of money at the time), as long as they could stay. But most subjects could only last 2-3 days, and no one could persist more than a week. They reported that initially they felt relaxed and wanted to sleep, but soon became irritable, unable to concentrate, experienced hallucinations (such as seeing a group of squirrels lining up), and their thinking became confused—this shows that without moderate sensory stimulation, the human mind cannot function normally.

35. Subliminal Perception

What it is: Also called "subconscious perception," referring to stimuli whose intensity is below the threshold of conscious awareness (you're not aware you saw/heard it), but the brain still processes the stimulus, and this processing affects your behavior, emotions, or judgments. The existence of subliminal perception shows that the brain can process information outside of consciousness.

Example: In an experiment, a word (such as "happy" or "sad") is quickly flashed on a screen, with the flash duration very short (tens of milliseconds), subjects aren't aware they saw the word, reporting "I didn't see anything." But next, when asked to judge the emotion of a neutral-expression person, subjects who just saw "happy" are more inclined to judge the person as happy, and those who saw "sad" are more inclined to judge as sad—although they aren't aware they saw the word, the word still affected their judgment, this is subliminal perception.

36. Synesthesia

What it is: Also called "cross-sensory perception," referring to a stimulus in one sensory modality automatically triggering an experience in another sensory modality. For example, hearing a certain sound causes you to see a certain color, tasting a certain flavor causes you to feel a certain shape, seeing a certain number makes you feel it's a certain color. Synesthesia is a stable, automatic, involuntary phenomenon, with about 1 in 2,000 people having synesthesia ability (some research says the proportion is higher). Synesthesia is not a disease, but a normal neurodiversity.

Example: A person with synesthesia, upon hearing middle C on the piano, automatically sees blue; upon hearing a violin's high note, sees bright yellow. For him, the number "3" is always red, the number "7" is always yellow—this color association is automatic, stable, present since childhood, not something he deliberately imagines. When he hears a symphony, a "feast of colors" appears before his eyes, with different instrument sounds corresponding to different colors and shapes—this is synesthesia, one sensory modality automatically triggering another.

Chapter 7: Consciousness, Psychoanalysis, and Object Relations

37. Manifest and Latent Content of Dreams

What it is: Core concepts in *Freud's* dream interpretation theory. Manifest content is the surface content of the dream, the plot, images, and story you can remember after waking up. Latent content is the hidden, unconscious true meaning behind the dream, usually repressed desires, impulses, and conflicts. Freud believed dreams are "symbolic satisfaction of unconscious wishes," and manifest content is the disguised manifestation of latent content through "dream work" (condensation, displacement, symbolism, secondary revision).

Example: A person dreams of rushing to catch a train, but no matter how hard he runs he can't catch it, and finally the train leaves, and he's very anxious. This is the manifest content (surface story). Through analysis, the latent content of this dream might be: he recently faces an important promotion opportunity at work, but feels unprepared and afraid of missing it, and the subconscious anxiety is expressed through the symbol of "missing the train"—the train represents opportunity, missing it represents fear of missing out. Manifest content is "catching the train," latent content is "anxiety about missing opportunities."

38. Daydreaming

What it is: In a waking state, attention turns from the external world to the internal, spontaneously producing a series of imaginations, fantasies, and storylines. Daydreams are usually pleasant, wish-fulfilling, such as fantasizing about success, fame, being loved, or experiencing adventure. Moderate daydreaming is normal and even beneficial (can relieve stress, stimulate creativity, plan for the future), but excessive indulgence in daydreaming that affects real-life functioning may be a problem.

Example: You're in a boring meeting, listening and then your mind wanders. You start fantasizing: you're suddenly recruited by a big company, with a million-yuan salary, reaching the peak of life; or fantasizing about winning the lottery, buying a big house, traveling the world. You "act out" a whole movie in your head, feeling great, until a colleague taps you and you snap back—this is daydreaming. It gives you temporary pleasure and satisfaction in a boring reality.

39. Stream of Consciousness

What it is: A concept proposed by William James, referring to consciousness not being pieced together from discrete "thoughts," but like a river, continuously flowing and changing. Our thoughts, feelings, and impressions flow one after another, with no clear breakpoints, and always changing—you can't have exactly the same thought twice. This concept was later borrowed by the literary world, forming "stream of consciousness literature" (such as works by Joyce and Woolf).

Example: You're now sitting by the window, and your consciousness might flow like this: "The weather is so nice today → sunlight on the table → that cup should be washed → yesterday I had dinner with a friend and talked about traveling → I really want to go to Japan → Japan's cherry blossoms → drinking under the cherry blossoms → what was that movie called → oh right, I still have a report to submit this afternoon → damn, I haven't written the report yet..." Your consciousness naturally flows from one thought to another, without logic, without breakpoints, like a river—this is the stream of consciousness.

40. Preconscious

What it is: A level in *Freud's* topographic theory of consciousness, between conscious and unconscious. Contents in the preconscious are things you're not currently aware of, but as long as you pay attention to think about them or recall them, you can easily bring them to the conscious level. For example, you're not currently thinking about your birthday, but if I ask you, you can immediately remember it—your birthday exists in the preconscious. The preconscious is like a "gatekeeper," controlling unconscious content entering consciousness.

Example: You're now reading this document, your attention is on these words (conscious). But your brain also stores a lot of information you're not currently thinking about but can recall at any time: your phone number, what you ate yesterday, your elementary school homeroom teacher's name, the melody of your favorite song... these all exist in the preconscious. As long as you turn your attention to them, they'll enter consciousness. The difference between preconscious and unconscious is: preconscious content can be easily brought to awareness, while unconscious content is repressed and difficult to directly become aware of.

41. Transference Neurosis

What it is: In psychoanalytic treatment, the client strongly transfers emotions, conflicts, and relationship patterns from past important figures (usually parents) onto the therapist, forming an emotional relationship similar to a neurosis. This transference neurosis is the core working material of psychoanalytic treatment—the therapist analyzes and interprets the transference to help the client understand their unconscious conflicts and relationship patterns, thereby gaining insight and change.

Example: A client had a strict, harsh father who always criticized and negated him. In treatment, he begins to perceive the therapist as that harsh father: when the therapist is silent, he feels the therapist is criticizing him; when the therapist interprets, he feels the therapist is negating him; he's both afraid of the therapist and craves the therapist's approval. This emotional reaction that re-emerges in the treatment relationship, similar to a neurosis, is transference neurosis. The therapist will analyze this transference with the client, helping him see "your feelings toward me now are actually your feelings toward your father from childhood," thereby gaining insight.

42. Holding Environment

What it is: A concept proposed by Winnicott (object relations theory), referring to a stable, containing, safe psychological environment that the mother (or caregiver) provides for the infant. In a holding environment, the mother can contain the infant's various emotions (including anger, anxiety, destructive impulses), not be overwhelmed by the infant's emotions, not retaliate against the infant, but steadily and gently "hold" the infant and their emotions. The holding environment is a necessary condition for the infant to form secure attachment and develop a true self. In psychotherapy, the therapist also needs to provide a holding environment for the client.

Example: A one-year-old baby, because his block tower fell, is very angry, crying and screaming, even hitting mom and throwing things. If mom gets angered, hits back or scolds "Why are you so disobedient," the baby will feel "my anger is terrible, mom can't stand me." But if mom calmly hugs him, gently saying "I know you're very angry, the blocks falling is really upsetting," containing his anger, not being carried away by his emotions, and not punishing him—this is the holding environment. In this environment, the baby learns: "My emotions can be contained, I am safe, I can have all kinds of emotions without being abandoned."

Chapter 8: Object Relations, Self Psychology, and Humanistic Psychology

43. Narcissism (Healthy/Pathological)

What it is: The core concept of Kohut's self psychology. Narcissism is not a "bad quality," but a normal psychological need everyone has—craving recognition, appreciation, feeling valuable and powerful. Healthy narcissism manifests as: stable self-esteem, able to appreciate oneself and others, able to accept criticism without collapsing, having empathy. Pathological narcissism (narcissistic personality disorder) manifests as: grandiose sense of self-importance, need for excessive admiration, lack of empathy, exploiting others, fragile self-esteem (criticism leads to rage or depression), envy of others or believing others envy them.

Example: Healthy narcissism person: achieves something at work, genuinely happy for himself, and can generously accept others' congratulations; when criticized, although a bit uncomfortable, can listen carefully and correct if needed; seeing others succeed, genuinely happy for them, even learning from their strengths. Pathological narcissism person: achieves a little and shows off everywhere, thinking he's a genius; criticized once and flies into a rage or secretly holds a grudge; seeing others succeed and feels jealous, sour, even belittling them "What's so great about him"; in relationships only cares about what he can get, not about others' feelings.

44. Grandiose Self

What it is: A concept in Kohut's self psychology, referring to a normal psychological state in early infancy—the infant feels omnipotent, perfect, the center of the world, everything under their control. This grandiosity is the foundation of healthy narcissism development. In normal development, through the caregiver's "mirroring" (appreciation, recognition, response) and moderate empathic failures, the grandiose self is gradually "tamed," transforming into healthy self-esteem, ambition, and initiative. If early mirroring is lacking, or severe trauma is experienced, the grandiose self cannot develop normally, possibly leading to pathological narcissism (either excessive grandiosity or extreme inferiority).

Example: A two-year-old child builds a crooked block tower, excitedly runs to mom: "Mom look! I built it! So tall!" At this moment his grandiose self is at work—he feels his creation is the most amazing in the world. If mom happily says: "Wow! Baby built it so tall! So amazing!" (mirroring), the child's grandiose self is satisfied and confirmed, gradually internalized into stable self-esteem. If mom says: "What's so great about that, it's crooked, look at neighbor's Chris who built much better" (lack of mirroring), the child's grandiose self is damaged, may become inferior, or to defend against inferiority becomes overly arrogant ("I'm the best, they just don't understand").

45. Positive Regard

What it is: A concept in Rogers' humanistic psychology, referring to warmth, acceptance, care, respect, and recognition from others. Everyone has a basic need for positive regard, especially in childhood. Parents' positive regard is the foundation for children to form healthy self-esteem and self-concept. But if positive regard is "conditional" (only if you're obedient, get good grades, meet my expectations, will I love you), the child will form "conditions of worth," only accepting the parts of themselves that meet the conditions, repressing the true self. Rogers believed that in psychotherapy, the therapist needs to provide "unconditional positive regard" to help the client restore their true self.

Example: A child scores 90 on an exam, happily runs home. If mom says: "Wow! You got 90! Mom is so proud of you! No matter what score you get, Mom loves you!" (unconditional positive regard), the child will feel "I am loved for who I am, my worth doesn't depend on scores." If mom says: "Only 90? Why not 100? Look at neighbor's Chris who got 100. Only getting 100 makes you a good child." (conditional positive regard), the child will feel "Only when I do well does Mom love me; if I don't do well, I'm not worthy of love"—his self-worth is tied to external conditions.

46. Existential Anxiety

What it is: A core concept in existential psychology, referring to a fundamental anxiety arising from facing the ultimate concerns of existence (death, freedom, loneliness, meaninglessness). Existential anxiety is not pathological, but an inherent part of human existence—as long as you're a self-aware person, you'll face these ultimate existential questions, thus producing anxiety. Existential anxiety can be constructive (motivating you to live seriously, make choices, find meaning), or overwhelming (leading to avoidance, numbness, psychological disorders). The goal of existential psychotherapy is not to eliminate existential anxiety, but to help the client face it, coexist with it, and find the courage and meaning of life from it.

Example: A person, on his 40th birthday, suddenly realizes: "I've lived half my life, time is limited, I will die someday. Is what I'm doing now really meaningful? Is my relationship with my family really good? Am I living the life I truly want?" These thoughts make him feel deep anxiety—this is existential anxiety, anxiety arising from facing the ultimate issues of death and meaninglessness. This anxiety can be constructive: it prompts him to re-examine his life, start spending more time with family, start doing what he truly wants to do, no longer wasting time on meaningless socializing. But if he can't bear this anxiety, he might avoid it—using work, alcohol, shopping, scrolling on his phone to numb himself, not thinking about these questions, but the anxiety will manifest in other forms (depression, physical symptoms).

47. Existential Vacuum

What it is: A concept proposed by *Frankl*, referring to a state of emptiness, boredom, and meaninglessness caused by frustration of the will to meaning and inability to find life's meaning. Existential vacuum is very common in modern society—when basic survival needs are met, people instead don't know "what living is for," feeling empty, bored, confused. Manifestations of existential vacuum include: boredom ("don't know what to do on weekends"), emptiness ("feel life is meaningless"), confusion ("don't know what I want"), and using various means (shopping, scrolling on phone, workaholism, addiction) to fill the emptiness. Existential vacuum can also lead to depression, anxiety, aggressive behavior, and other psychological problems.

Example: A 30-year-old young person works at a big company, good salary, has a house and car, everyone thinks he's very successful. But he feels empty and bored every day, "Work is just drifting, after work is just scrolling on phone, weekends I don't know what to do, feel life is meaningless. Sometimes I think: what is the point of living?" He's tried buying luxury goods, traveling, changing jobs, but they only provide temporary relief, and after a while he returns to emptiness—this is existential vacuum. His basic needs are all met, but the will to meaning is not satisfied, he hasn't found the meaning of his life. Frankl would help him explore: what makes him feel valuable? What does he care about? What can he contribute to others, to the world? By finding meaning, to fill the existential vacuum.

48. Self-Transcendence

What it is: *Maslow's* later revision and supplement to the hierarchy of needs—above self-actualization, there's a higher level: self-transcendence. Self-transcendence refers to transcending personal self-interest, focusing on something greater than oneself (others, society, the universe, spirit, meaning), and gaining the deepest satisfaction and meaning in serving goals beyond the personal self. Self-transcenders no longer focus on "what can I get" "what can I achieve," but on "what can I contribute" "what can I do for the greater good." Self-transcendence is usually accompanied by peak experiences, plateau experiences, and a profound sense of meaning.

Example: A scientist, whose goal when young was "become famous, win awards, prove I'm the smartest" (self-actualization level). After years of research and growth, his motivation changed. He no longer cares about personal honors and fame, but devotes himself entirely to research because he believes this research can help humanity solve major problems (such as curing diseases, addressing climate change). He says: "I do research not for myself, but because this thing is worth doing. If my research can help others, that's my greatest satisfaction." He even donated all his patents and prize money to charity in his later years. His focus shifted from "self" to a greater goal beyond self—this is self-transcendence.

Chapter 9: Intelligence, Measurement, and Research Methods

49. Fluid Intelligence

What it is: One type in *Cattell's* intelligence theory, referring to the ability that doesn't depend on prior knowledge and experience, but on the brain's neurophysiological functions, used for solving new problems, abstract reasoning, and quickly processing information. Fluid intelligence includes: logical reasoning, abstract thinking, working memory, reaction speed, pattern recognition, etc. Fluid intelligence peaks in adolescence, then gradually declines with age (due to the decline of the brain's neurophysiological functions).

Example: You're given a puzzle you've never seen before: "1, 1, 2, 3, 5, 8, ?" and asked to find the pattern and fill in the next number. You don't need any prior knowledge, just observation, reasoning, and finding the pattern—this is fluid intelligence at work. Another example: you play a new puzzle game for the first time, nobody teaches you the rules, you quickly grasp the gameplay through trial and reasoning—this is also fluid intelligence. People with high fluid intelligence can quickly find solutions when facing completely new problems.

50. Crystallized Intelligence

What it is: Opposite to fluid intelligence, referring to knowledge, skills, vocabulary, common sense, etc. acquired through later learning and experience. Crystallized intelligence depends on education and experience, it's "what you've learned." Crystallized intelligence includes: vocabulary, common sense, professional knowledge, language comprehension, judgment, etc. Unlike fluid intelligence, crystallized intelligence continues to grow throughout life (as long as you keep learning), and may only decline in old age due to cognitive decline.

Example: An old traditional Chinese medicine doctor with 30 years of experience, although his reaction speed and memory may not be as good as young people (fluid intelligence decline), he has accumulated rich medical knowledge and clinical experience, can accurately judge the condition at a glance at the patient's symptoms, and prescribe effective medicine—this is crystallized intelligence at work, accumulated over decades of learning and experience. Another example: a person's vocabulary, understanding of historical events, insight into human affairs, these all belong to crystallized intelligence, and they will continuously enrich with age and experience.

51. Multiple Intelligences (Linguistic/Logical/Spatial, etc.)

What it is: A theory proposed by *Gardner*, opposing the traditional singular view of intelligence (believing intelligence is just linguistic and logical-mathematical ability), holding that human intelligence is multiple, including at least eight relatively independent intelligences:

① Linguistic intelligence (language expression and understanding);
② Logical-mathematical intelligence (mathematical operations and logical reasoning);
③ Spatial intelligence (visual-spatial thinking, sense of direction);
④ Bodily-kinesthetic intelligence (body control and motor ability);
⑤ Musical intelligence (music perception, rhythm, melody);
⑥ Interpersonal intelligence (understanding others, social ability);
⑦ Intrapersonal intelligence (self-awareness, emotion management);
⑧ Naturalistic intelligence (observing and understanding the natural world). Everyone has these eight intelligences, but the combinations and strengths differ.

Example: A student, whose English and math scores are poor (weak linguistic and logical-mathematical intelligence), but he's especially good at sports, a key player on the school team (strong bodily-kinesthetic intelligence); he's also especially good at making friends, classmates all like him (strong interpersonal intelligence); he's especially interested in nature, can recognize many plants and insects (strong naturalistic intelligence). According to the traditional view of intelligence, he might be considered a "stupid student," but according to multiple intelligences theory, he just has different strengths in different intelligences—his talent isn't in books, but in sports, socializing, and natural observation. Gardner believes education should respect each person's intelligence combination, teach according to aptitude, rather than measuring everyone by a single standard.

52. IQ (Ratio/Deviation)

What it is: Intelligence Quotient (IQ), a quantitative indicator measuring intelligence level. Early ratio IQ: IQ = (mental age/chronological age) × 100. For example, an 8-year-old child with a mental age of 10 (can complete tasks for 10-year-olds), his IQ is (10/8) × 100 = 125. But ratio IQ has a problem: adults' intelligence doesn't grow linearly with age, so ratio IQ only applies to children. Later, deviation IQ was developed: with the same-age group's average IQ as 100, standard deviation as 15, calculating IQ based on a person's relative position in their age group. Deviation IQ applies to all age groups.

Example: A 10-year-old child, whose score on an intelligence test is the same as the average level of 12-year-olds, his mental age is 12, ratio IQ is (12/10) × 100 = 120. A 30-year-old adult, calculated using deviation IQ: his score on the intelligence test is one standard deviation (15 points) above the average of his age group (25-34), then his deviation IQ is 100 + 15 = 115. This means his intelligence level is higher than about 84% of people in his age group. Deviation IQ reflects a person's relative position among peers, not absolute intelligence level.

53. Survivorship Bias

What it is: A special form of selection bias, referring to only focusing on "surviving" samples (those that still exist after some screening), while ignoring "disappeared" samples (those eliminated during screening, not observed), thus drawing wrong conclusions. Survivorship bias leads to excessive optimism—because you only see successes, not failures, you overestimate the probability and feasibility of success.

Example: The classic "WWII aircraft armor" example: statisticians analyzed the bullet hole distribution on successfully returned bombers, finding the most bullet holes on wings and fuselage, fewest on engines and cockpit. The military initially decided to reinforce the wings and fuselage with the most bullet holes. But statistician Abraham Wald pointed out: should reinforce the areas with the fewest bullet holes (engines and cockpit)—because aircraft hit in these areas didn't make it back (were shot down), so you don't see bullet holes in these areas on returned aircraft; the areas you see with many bullet holes are precisely the less lethal areas where the aircraft could still fly back after being hit. This is survivorship bias—only looking at "surviving" aircraft, ignoring "non-surviving" aircraft. Life example: "My friend smoked until 90 and was fine, so smoking is fine"—you only see the "survivor" who smoked and lived long, not those who died early because of smoking.

54. Availability Heuristic

What it is: One of the cognitive heuristics proposed by Kahneman and Tversky, referring to people judging the probability or frequency of an event based on "how easily this event comes to mind in memory"—the easier to recall, the more common and likely they think it is. Availability heuristic is effective in most cases (common things are indeed more easily remembered), but it's influenced by media reports, personal experience, emotional intensity, and other factors, leading to judgment bias—events that are widely reported, vivid, and emotional are more easily recalled, thus overestimating their probability.

Example: Many people think flying is very dangerous, because news of plane crashes is always widely reported, the images are shocking, easily recalled. But actually, from statistical data, airplanes are one of the safest modes of transportation, with extremely low probability of fatal accidents (about one in several million), much safer than cars and trains. But because plane crashes are more easily reported by media and more easily remembered (high availability), people overestimate the danger of flying. Another example: many people think "crime rates are getting higher and higher now," because news always reports various criminal incidents. But actually, crime rates in many places are declining—it's just that media reports are more frequent, criminal incidents are more easily recalled, so people think crime is increasing. Availability heuristic makes us judge probability based on "how easily it comes to mind" rather than real statistical data, thus producing bias.

To Kill a Mockingbird

In a Small Town Full of Prejudice, Who Killed the Mockingbird?

In 1962, director Robert Mulligan brought Harper Lee's novel *To Kill a Mockingbird* to the screen. The novel won the Pulitzer Prize. In black and white, the small Southern town of Maycomb appears slowly. The story begins with a girl's memory—Jean Louise Finch, whom people call Scout. She and her brother Jem, and their summer friend Dill, run and play in the streets. They are also afraid of the "strange man" Boo in the Radley house next door.

But this quiet town is divided by a case.

1. The Secret in the Tree Hole



Stage Photo

Scout's father, Atticus Finch, is a lawyer in Maycomb. He is honest and calm, and he raises the two children alone. He tells Scout and Jem that they can play with an air gun, but they must never shoot a mockingbird. A mockingbird does nothing bad. It only sings for people. To kill a mockingbird is a sin.

The children are very curious about the Radley house. People say that Boo Radley did something wrong when he was young, and his father kept him inside. After that, he never came out. He became a ghost in the town's stories. But slowly, Scout and Jem find that this "strange man" is not scary. In a tree hole, they find gum, coins, small soap dolls, and a watch. Jem's pants, torn on a fence at night, are sewn and folded and put back. On the night Miss Maudie's house catches fire, a blanket appears on Scout's shoulders. Boo has been watching over them quietly from the dark.

2. The Mockingbird in Court

Atticus takes a case that he almost cannot win. A young Black man, Tom Robinson, is accused of raping a white woman, Mayella Ewell. In that small Southern town, prejudice against Black people is strong. Defending a Black man means Atticus has to face jokes, threats, and loneliness. The children are insulted at school, but Atticus tells them: Do not fight. Hold your head up. Be brave.

In court, the truth comes out bit by bit. The Ewells live next to the dump. Mayella's father, Bob Ewell, drinks and is violent. Mayella is lonely and unhappy. She tries to get Tom's attention, but her father finds out. Bob beats his daughter and forces her to accuse Tom. Atticus proves that Mayella's right eye is hurt. This means the person who hit her used his left hand. Bob is left-handed. Tom's left hand was hurt long ago, so he could not have hit her with his left hand. Tom only helped Mayella out of pity, but he is put on trial.

In his final speech, Atticus says that a court should be a place where everyone is equal. Rich or poor, smart or not, everyone should be equal in court. But the jury still finds Tom guilty. It is not the evidence that wins. It is prejudice. In great sadness and hopelessness, Tom tries to escape and is shot dead by a guard. The innocent mockingbird dies because of people's coldness and hate.

3. A Guardian in the Dark

After the trial, Bob Ewell wins the case, but his name is ruined. He hates Atticus. He threatens him in town, and then he turns his anger on Scout and Jem. On Halloween night, the two children walk home from a school play. Bob attacks them in the dark. Jem's arm is broken. Scout is trapped in her costume and can hardly fight back.

In the confusion, a figure rushes out and saves them. Bob Ewell falls under a tree with a knife in his chest. Scout sees a pale, thin man in the crowd. He leans against the wall and says almost nothing. Later she learns that it is Boo Radley. The "strange man" they once thought was a ghost has come out of his house at the most dangerous moment.

Sheriff Tate insists that Bob fell on his own knife. He does not want Boo to be brought into public attention. At first Atticus thinks Jem killed the man, but Tate tells him: Let the dead bury the dead. Protect Boo, just as we protect a mockingbird. Boo has been locked away and misunderstood all his life, yet he has done the kindest thing. If he were put on trial and made to face the town's talk and curiosity, that would be truly cruel.

4. Standing in Another Person's Shoes

Finally, Scout walks Boo home. She stands on the porch of the Radley house and looks at the whole street from Boo's point of view for the first time. She remembers her father's words: You never really know a person until you stand in his shoes and walk around in them. At that moment, she understands. Boo is not a monster. Tom is not a criminal. They are just two mockingbirds hurt by the world.

At the end of the film, adult Scout's narration speaks softly. Atticus says that when you finally understand people, most of them are good. But it is also the silence, prejudice, and fear of most people that kill the innocent mockingbird.

To Kill a Mockingbird is not just a court story. It is about growing up, about courage, and about how a father teaches his children to keep their sense of right and wrong in a world full of prejudice.

Gregory Peck's Atticus Finch has become one of the greatest heroes in film history. He has no gun and no superpower. He stands against the town with only honesty, understanding of others' feelings, and courage when he is alone.

The black-and-white images take away the noise of color, but they make the story heavier and clearer. The mockingbird is still singing. People just often refuse to hear it.

MY 50 YEARS IN INFINEURAL

Download the game on mikeklubnika.itch.io/infineural

When I walked through that door, I knew nothing.

The reception room was very small. The fluorescent light buzzed. In the corner stood a battered vending machine. On the table, a piece of paper said: "*Thank you for signing up to the Infineural 'Eternal Captcha' program. As we mentioned earlier, the coffee we provide has anaesthetic properties. After drinking it, please step into the automatic escort vehicle and relax. If you find that you don't remember anything after the test is over, do not be alarmed. It is only the side effect of the beverage.*"

This was no different from what I had heard before.

I went over to the vending machine and bought a cup of coffee. Steam rose from the cup. A cheaply printed design ran around the rim of the paper cup. I picked up the cup. The coffee was not hot, and it tasted thin and bland, like instant powder mixed with too much water. I drank it all.

After that, I remembered nothing at all.

When I woke up, I had already completed my work and been paid. I walked out of the company's door; in reality, only five minutes had passed.

The company was by the sea. I sat on a chair by the waterfront. A man sat next to me. He glanced at me and said, "Oh, hey there. I got off the test just a few minutes before you." I touched my face and felt that nothing had changed. But he said he was curious about what it was like over here. He knew that some people hadn't drunk the coffee, so after coming out they still remembered what had happened inside. "Those people later all…" He didn't finish.



Game Photo

"And maybe that's for the best."

Fifty years for five minutes—I had paid almost no price. It was a bargain. That was what I thought at the time. In my ecstasy, I walked into the company again, into the company's vehicle. Only this time, I didn't drink the coffee…

The anesthesia did not take effect. I was completely awake. I sat at a metal table, in front of an old IBM computer. A hard chair. Gray walls. No window. No sound. The screen lit up. The first question appeared. I reached out and typed the first answer. Then the second. The third.

At first, everything was still normal. Or rather, they weren't questions, but more like psychological tests.

Thirty years later, I had answered 5,492,946 questions, and I had not gotten a single one wrong. But then I answered one question wrong—a question that seemed to have no standard answer at all. At that point, WATCHDOG noticed, and increased my quota by fifty thousand questions. Only then did I truly feel the horror of it.

I answered nine million questions. I got many wrong. Every time I got one wrong, the quota increased by fifty thousand. Time would not stop because I was exhausted. I tried closing my eyes, I tried screaming, I tried banging my head against the table, but it was no use. *Because the original host, the test-subject's body, is not deemed suitable for the test due to the axiomatic life-span of the human body. And the test-subject's encephalon is automatically transferred to a temporary host, which the conscious will inhabit for the duration of the test. Moreover, because the temporary host consists of synthetic materials, so that will not degrade in the warp-drive domain.* So even death did not belong to me there.

For fifty years, my fingers kept striking the keyboard to choose answers, and my eyes kept staring at the cold glowing screen. I remembered that first cup of coffee. It turned out it wasn't a bargain; it was mercy. It made me forget all of this. And the second time, I chose to remember.

When the fifty years ended, I walked out of the vehicle, and outside only five minutes had passed again. That cup of coffee—the first time, I drank it; this time, I didn't.

I walked out of Infineural. The sunlight outside was good. The people on the street had experienced only five minutes, but my mind held fifty years, fifty years of imprisoned memory. The sound of the keyboard was still ringing. Nine million questions were still scrolling before my eyes.

The man was still sitting there. "Oh, you're out. How does it feel? … Are you okay?"

Fifty years of conscious imprisonment had long since made me forget how to communicate with people, even how to speak. I didn't answer him. I walked straight away.

I returned to my apartment and closed the door. I wrote this down.

Right when I am done tying the noose, I hear an ad on the radio:

"INFINEURAL LOOKING FOR VOLUNTEERS"

GAME INTRODUCTION

Infineural is a short psychological horror game which only really starts to shock you once you begin to really contemplate what just happened in it.

Infineural is a short time dilation horror game where you go look to earn a lot of extra cash for just five minutes of your time. You've agreed to partake in a research study at a mysterious facility called Infineural. It seems they have the ability to transfer your consciousness to a robotic body and use warp drive technology to stretch one minute into ten years. So for every one minute that passes in normal time, ten years will have passed in the facility. You have no idea what happens during that time and doesn't really matter though as you won't remember any of it. As long as you drink a special coffee anyway…

It's a great little game that gets more horrifying the more you think about it. There are no jump scares or monsters, just a touch of dark humor and a very clever Sci-Fi premise. Just be sure to drink that coffee!

(This game has flashing images & features suicidal topics. Player discretion is advised.)

unhappy

by s0rrow



Every day we talk a little less
It looks like you are losing interest
These feelings I have for you
But you don't feel the same
So I'll pack all my things
And go run far away

You are, you are very pretty
I'm so very ugly
Will you even love me, anymore (love me)
You can, you can live without me
That makes me unhappy
I should get a piercing through my heart

What do you even want me to be
You never ever pay attention to me
So I'll close my blinds in misery
And I'll wait for you for a couple of weeks

You are, you are very pretty
I'm so very ugly
Will you even love me, anymore (love me)
You can, you can live without me
That makes me unhappy
I should get a piercing through my heart

Poppy Crown

by JUSF Zhou Cun,

Luo Tianyi,

Kagamine Len

Des phy Sallauphe syou chweegh (I give you deep loneliness)
Defoe tin Sallauknoe phecheey yahh (I give you supreme happiness)

I believe loneliness is an inescapable fate
I believe language is a machine that destroys thought
I believe communication is a blind, merciless exposure
Everyone closed their eyes to guess
I believe loneliness will force my heart to open
I believe language will awaken my heavy love
I believe communication will lead me to gain the qualification
To enjoy eternal peace by his side

The poppy crown is placed on her head
Tightly binding the violated thoughts
As if she too once fell silent because of love
Seeking a faith beyond the perception of the five senses
The poppy crown is placed on her head
The moment it is worn, death is proclaimed
Despair never descends without cause
Unless you have smelled the fragrance of hell

I believe acceptance is the duty of staying alive
I believe creation is happiness from the heart
I believe meaning is an enduring, ever-changing truth
The most exquisitely beautiful thing
I believe acceptance will pave the road ahead
I believe creation will decide the destination of my heart
I believe meaning will fade yet never vanish
Quietly awaiting the prophecy of rebirth
The poppy crown is placed on her head
Deeply piercing the despised desire
Through the half-shut door leaks a trace of light
Mingled with holy singing from afar
The poppy crown is placed on her head
The moment it is worn, death is proclaimed
Punishment never descends without cause
Unless you have smelled the fragrance of hell

Des phy Sallau ksoekoo chy (I give you the right to live)
Des phoety Sallaukwuug sapcky (I thought you would cherish her)
Des phy Sallau syou coutti (So I give you a profound prayer)
Desouphy chysameensa phoegh (I originally hoped you would fall in love with her)

Daase cah tinnoa tootty ca (Abandoned freedom)
/ Safiiylla Sheeysaphesoo (To you whom I love most deeply)
Dashee kha tiisayhou phoesey (Abandoned the most authentic existence)
/ Safiiylla Sheeysallassou (To you whom I detest most)
Des khee haeh suu tokhouu (Focusing on empirical things)
/ Safiiylla Sheeysaphesoo (To you whom I love most deeply)
Des phoettee SAABBAY SSAH HAAGH (What a pitiful person)
/ Safiiylla Sheeysallassou (To you whom I detest most)

Her hair all grows inward / Who is struggling in pain
Until the strands are wet beyond measure, soaked with brain matter /
Delusion trying to break iron shackles
Only then can she no longer be lost / Little does she know this life
Every decision is not absurd / Death's hour was long ago set
So look, this is nothing but a farce / Those who still smile
Until the very end, no one sighs / Optimistic to the point of fear
Only fate is still shocked, refusing to believe / The dream of the mob
In fact, sorrow died long ago / Depicting a broken fairy tale

The poppy crown is placed on her head
Deeply piercing the despised desire
Through the half-shut door leaks a trace of light
Mingled with holy singing from afar
The poppy crown is placed on her head
The moment it is worn, death is proclaimed
Punishment never descends without cause
Unless you have smelled the fragrance of hell

The poppy crown is placed on her head
Constantly reminding her not to give up resistance
That sorrow with no driftwood to cling to
Boiled into this rich, sweet fragrance
The poppy crown is placed on her head
The moment it is worn, death is proclaimed
Reason never descends without cause
Unless you have smelled the fragrance of the poppy

Word Search

Z D U P M C R T H B S P E C I A L M
Q H T A O A O O A U I A N T E Y E B
I E N R U Z G M B D O R L R K M D F
D G M T A Z O A E I F T A H D F E S
E W J Y K G U N Z T N Y N I E B P U
M N S P X X E A B I Q G G D X M E N
E Y M O R A V D Z O N O U D Z E F H
N U N O N D Y Y Y M H E A E X C N A
T R H P M E T E O R Y R G N N P T P
I M U E H E A R T A C H E N X Q D P
A I V R A A M K F M M O C K I N G Y
V T H W B A C K R O O M S S H G I F

Find the following words in the puzzle.
Words are hidden → and ↓ and ↘

BACKROOMS
COMET
DEMENTIA
HEARTACHE
HIDDEN
LANGUAGE
MAGAZINE
METEOR
MOCKING
PARTYGOER
PARTYPOOPER
ROBIN
SPECIAL
TRAGEDY
UNHAPPY

AFTERWORD

Hello, nice to meet you.
I'm Meteor, the author of Comet Magazine.
Thank you for taking time out of your busy schedule to read the third issue I have made.

This issue is a special edition. Why is it called a special edition? Because among the magazines I have made so far, it is the only one with a theme of its own (*Who Killed Cock Robin*), and it is a test version—to see how people respond.

In June 2026, I had the idea to create this issue. At the time, I saw the article "*Who Killed Cock Robin*" in the Unnamed Levels of C Cluster on the Wikidot version of the Backrooms, and it sparked my interest. Especially after reading that article, I resolved to create a new magazine. But choosing the content gave me trouble: I wanted to add something new, but what? After much thought, I decided to add a manga. But then choosing which manga gave me trouble again, and I could not find a suitable one for a long time, so it stayed on hold until August 2026, when I discovered artist Iroha's *The Varied Winds of Life* (Japanese original title: とりどりのかぜ), and the whole production could continue. Since I could not find an English version of this manga, I had to use the Chinese version. But after we had worked on it for a while, we realized that the manga's content was far too much and not very suitable to put entirely into the magazine (otherwise it would turn into the previous issue's situation of "one magazine, half of it on the same theme"). Reluctantly, I had no choice but to print the manga separately as an A5 booklet as a bonus gift. This is another reason the magazine is called a "special edition."

While looking for material, I found a film called "*TO KILL A MOCKINGBIRD*" (the Chinese translated title is "杀死一只知更鸟"). Although the English nursery rhyme on the opening pages, the unnamed level in the Backrooms' C Cluster, and this film are not very closely related, there is still a slight connection. Of course, it is not only in the name; I also feel that all of these tend to depict the theme of "hidden truth." Therefore, I included them all. In addition, the male lead of this film is Gregory Peck (he also played the protagonist of *The Million Pound Note*).

When everyone sees the front and back covers, they might also wonder: What do these words and sentences mean? The cover's "Des phy Sallau syou coutti" means "So I give you a profound prayer." This sentence originally comes from the header "祈愿 · Des phy Sallau syou coutti" of the hidden level "Who Killed Cock Robin" in Backrooms C Cluster. Later, when I looked into this sentence carefully, I found its source— "Poppy Crown," sung by Luo Tianyi (which also happens to correspond to the background behind that header). It belongs to a constructed language and originally has no actual meaning, but the meaning marked on the cover follows that header.

As for "Zankon" on the back cover, it comes from Japanese and means "Residual Scars."

Most of the sources for this magazine come from the internet. If you want to understand certain content in detail, you can search online yourself.

Finally, the digital edition of the magazine is open! You can send an email with the specified subject and content to meteorpersonal@outlook.com, and we will reply within 3 business days.

The specified subject and content for this issue are “Cock Robin”; the specified subject and content for the manga are “Sota.”

What? You read all the way here? You really are patient! Thank you very much for listening to me ramble on so much. I may indeed be a bit of a rambler :). But no matter what, I have written everything I wanted to write. Thank you all for your support, and thanks to the Wikidot version of the Backrooms for providing information about the Backrooms, artist Iroha for the manga, and the many creators of the content I included in my magazine. I am endlessly grateful to you all!!

Comet Magazine · Velox Et Luminosus

Meteor
October, 2026

PLUS

From now on, this will be my anime-style persona,

and I will often use this persona to meet everyone!





Soren

“Forever” does not exist.

If it did, it would be nothing but a self-serving illusion.

The “forever” that once promised someone

will one day become nothing more than a Zankon in someone's heart.

